

Stakeholder Question Catalogue

Auditors and Certification Assessors

STAKEHOLDER 35

80 practical questions across eight evidence-led categories. The catalogue supports authorised evidence discovery, point-in-time provenance, technically bounded analysis and independent assessor judgement without issuing assurance or certification decisions.

EIGHT CATEGORIES

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|---|---|
| 1 Scope, criteria, standards and responsibilities | 5 Sampling, observation, corroboration and limitations |
| 2 Evidence sources, provenance, currency and permissions | 6 Exceptions, nonconformities and corrective actions |
| 3 Assets, records, controls and accountable owners | 7 Traceability, retention, versioning and reproducibility |
| 4 Process operation, monitoring and control effectiveness | 8 Reporting, assurance boundaries and certification decisions |

Evidence support for independent assessment

Purpose, scope and operating boundaries

Purpose and audience

Supports authorised evidence discovery, source checking, sample preparation, corroboration, limitation recording and factual handover for auditors and certification assessors. It is not a standard, assessment programme, finding register or decision mechanism.

Proposed sensing and analytics

Every sensor, integration, model and calculation remains proposed until deployment, asset/location mapping, commissioning, permission, calibration or reference status, clock alignment and current health are independently verified. Plausible data is not automatically assessment evidence.

Authoritative precedence

Applicable law, scheme rules, signed scope decisions, controlled records, current source owners and competent professionals take precedence over dashboards, summaries, inferred states and telemetry. Conflicts and contrary originals remain visible.

Historical spatial reference

The May 2021 Abacws floor plan is historical spatial reference only. It cannot establish current room use, access, services, hazards, occupancy, equipment, closures, control scope or accountable ownership.

Independent judgement

The assessor controls the programme, populations, samples, procedures, sufficiency, materiality, findings and report judgement. The authorised certification function remains separate. The service only organises authorised facts, methods, uncertainty and limitations.

Safe failure and privacy

Where authority, permission, mapping, health, time alignment, provenance, population or minimum evidence is unverified, return 'insufficient verified evidence', state the missing condition and stop the affected operation. Use role-, asset-, system-, zone- and time-window evidence; do not identify or track people.

Question card field guide

Stakeholder question

A natural decision question a competent assessor may ask. It states the point-in-time decision without presuming conformity or a certification result.

Sensors and telemetry

Proposed, privacy-preserving support with modality, location, population coverage, sample or aggregation interval, calibration/reference needs, clock alignment, uptime, gaps, drift, provenance and explicit limits.

Authoritative supporting data

Current source owners, records and precedence; effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; permissions, lineage, staleness and unresolved conflicts.

Analysis required

Named operation type, decision interval, minimum evidence, transparent method, quantified uncertainty and a safe-failure output.

Answer boundary

What the service must not infer, disclose, promise, certify, authorise, control, alter or decide. Independent professional judgement remains outside the service.

Why this is useful

The concrete assessor action enabled: confirm scope, request evidence, extend testing, qualify a statement, preserve a limitation or prepare a bounded handover.

OPERATION TYPES

Lookup

retrieve an authorised value or record

Forecast

describe a bounded future scenario, never a promise

Observation

record a direct or instrumented state

Comparison

contrast periods, populations, versions or sources

Calculation

apply deterministic arithmetic or rules

Diagnosis

test competing explanations without unsupported causality

Estimate

state a value with quantified uncertainty

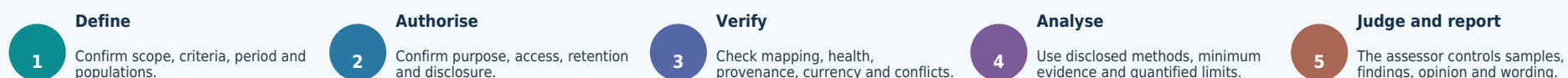
Recommendation

propose an assessor-controlled next action, not a judgement

Catalogue map and assessor-led use

Range	Category	Primary assessor decision supported
AU-001 to AU-010	Scope, criteria, standards and responsibilities	Agree the commissioned boundary, criteria, interfaces and accountable roles.
AU-011 to AU-020	Evidence sources, provenance, currency and permissions	Decide which sources may support testing or require permission, validation or corroboration.
AU-021 to AU-030	Assets, records, controls and accountable owners	Define reliable asset, record and control populations with accountable owners.
AU-031 to AU-040	Process operation, monitoring and control effectiveness	Select operating instances for control testing and identify monitoring blind intervals.
AU-041 to AU-050	Sampling, observation, corroboration and limitations	Control population freeze, sampling, observation triangulation and explicit limitations.
AU-051 to AU-060	Exceptions, nonconformities and corrective actions	Evaluate candidate matters and corrective-action evidence without automated classification.
AU-061 to AU-070	Traceability, retention, versioning and reproducibility	Verify point-in-time traceability, retention, integrity, version history and reproducibility.
AU-071 to AU-080	Reporting, assurance boundaries and certification decisions	Prepare bounded factual reporting and a complete package for independent certification decision.

ASSESSOR-LED USE SEQUENCE



ANALYTICAL GATES ARE NOT CONFORMITY THRESHOLDS

Minimum evidence decides only whether an operation is technically defensible; competent assessors and scheme functions decide sufficiency and outcome.

AU-001

Assessment boundary

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

At assessment opening, which organisational units, sites, floors, systems, processes and dates are formally in scope, and which exclusions have named approval?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Read-only inventory heartbeats, registered meter and control-system endpoints, integration status and asset identifiers may show where potential evidence channels exist. Coverage: Candidate buildings, floors, zones, services, processes and assets named by the assessment sponsor. Timing: Five-minute source health, summarised daily, plus a point-in-time inventory snapshot at planning and after any approved scope change. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Unmapped or duplicate IDs, renamed zones, uncommissioned integrations, packet loss and silent assets can create false coverage. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning, the opening meeting and every material change to entity, site, process, system or period. Minimum evidence: A signed scope, exact assessment dates, current entity/site/system lists, explicit exclusions, accountable owners and an authorised change history. Method: Criterion-to-boundary crosswalk and inclusion classification; join each criterion to organisational, spatial, temporal, process and technology boundaries; label every item included, excluded or unresolved. Uncertainty: Report the percentage of candidate items mapped, counts of unresolved boundaries and items changed after the scope date; show the last verified date for each register. Safe failure: Return 'scope not verified' for unresolved boundaries and suppress any completeness statement.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessment sponsor, scheme manager, estates information owner and relevant system owners. Primary records: The signed engagement or certification application, scheme rules, approved scope statement, current legal-entity, site, process, asset and system registers, and recorded exclusions. Precedence: Mandatory external requirements and the signed scope decision outrank local dashboards, uncontrolled lists, telemetry discovery and historical drawings. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict detailed scope and security architecture to the assessor and authorised evidence owners. Flag changed locations, unsupported exclusions and differences between signed scope, current registers and local owner statements. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not define the commissioned scope, accept an exclusion, infer current room use, access, service, hazard or closure from the May 2021 plan, or decide that an item is auditable. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to agree a defensible boundary, direct evidence requests to the right owners and avoid testing outside the commissioned assessment.

AU-002

Criteria and edition

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which standard or scheme edition, amendments, transition provisions and clause set apply to each in-scope requirement on its effective date?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: evidence catalogue may tag data channels and controlled records to candidate clause identifiers and show when mappings change. Coverage: In-scope control domain and evidence-producing system, excluding licensed standard text that the user is not entitled to view. Timing: Event-driven on document publication or mapping change, with a monthly check for orphaned or superseded clause links. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Incorrect clause numbers, incomplete licensed text, local interpretations and delayed transition updates can make a technically correct mapping legally irrelevant. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - during planning and whenever an edition, amendment, interpretation or transition date changes. Minimum evidence: The commissioned scheme, exact edition, amendments, transition dates, jurisdiction, applicability decision and authorised clause list. Method: Version-controlled criterion register and bidirectional clause-to-control crosswalk; map criterion to control, evidence source and planned procedure while preserving unmapped, disputed and licence-restricted items. Uncertainty: Quantify unmapped and disputed clauses, days to transition, and the proportion of control links supported only by local interpretation. Safe failure: Name the unresolved edition or clause and do not generate a criterion conclusion.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the scheme owner, legal or compliance function, document control and assessment sponsor. Primary records: Licensed standards, amendments, certification scheme rules, accreditation decisions, statutory and contractual registers, approved interpretations and controlled internal policies. Precedence: The formally commissioned edition, mandatory transition provisions and authorised legal or scheme interpretations outrank internal summaries and historic mappings. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Respect copyright and licence limits; disclose clause references or authorised extracts only. Flag superseded editions, overlapping transition periods, unofficial copies and conflicting interpretations. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not give legal advice, choose the applicable scheme, make a definitive interpretation of a disputed clause, or reproduce licensed text beyond permission. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents testing against the wrong edition and exposes transition, licensing and interpretation issues before fieldwork.

AU-003

Certification unit and interfaces

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which legal entity and management-system boundary form the certification unit, and where do responsibilities pass to other campus functions?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Service-interface heartbeats, meter demarcations, asset ownership tags and registered system endpoints may corroborate technical interfaces. Coverage: Interfaces between the proposed certification unit and central estates, IT, safety, procurement, landlords, utilities and outsourced providers. Timing: Fifteen-minute interface status aggregated daily, plus snapshots at the start and end of the selected assessment period. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Technical connectivity may persist after organisational transfer, and disconnected systems may still be contractually controlled. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at scoping, after organisational or contractual change, and before relying on a shared service. Minimum evidence: Current entity identifier, addresses, functions, management-system statement, interface owner, service period and responsibility allocation for every material dependency. Method: Entity-and-interface boundary model; create a directed interface map linking service provider, recipient, control responsibility, evidence owner and applicable period. Uncertainty: Report the percentage of interfaces with signed allocation, counts with no owner or dual ownership, and dates where entity or service status is ambiguous. Safe failure: Mark the affected interface unresolved and exclude it from completeness claims.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: legal or secretariat functions, the sponsor, estates, IT and relevant service owners. Primary records: Legal-entity and address registers, the management-system manual, leases, service schedules, organisational charts, delegation instruments and interface agreements. Precedence: Constitutive legal documents, the signed certification application and approved management-system boundary outrank organisational charts, technical topology and telemetry. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Limit sensitive legal and architecture detail to authorised roles. Flag unsigned service arrangements, entities renamed during the period and interfaces claimed by both or neither party. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer legal liability, employer status, operational control or certification eligibility from technical connectivity, location or organisational naming. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Defines the assessable unit and shows where interface testing or third-party evidence is needed.

AU-004

Accountability map

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For every criterion, control, evidence source and action, which current role is accountable, operating, consulted, approving and deputising?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: System-owner metadata, workflow role assignments, approval-route events and service-desk queues may show how responsibility is configured and exercised at role level. Coverage: In-scope controls, evidence repositories, approval steps and open corrective actions. Timing: Event-level role changes and approvals, summarised weekly by control and role, with a point-in-time role snapshot for each sampled event. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Stale directories, acting appointments, shared accounts, delegated approval and role names that differ across systems can misstate accountability. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning, for every selected sample and when an owner or delegation changes. Minimum evidence: In-scope criterion, control, source and action linked to one accountable role, operational responsibility, evidence owner and authorised approver for the relevant date. Method: Responsibility and authorisation matrix with orphan and overlap tests; temporal join of responsibilities to sampled events, highlighting missing, duplicate and incompatible assignments. Uncertainty: Report percentages with verified accountability, counts of orphan or dual-accountable items, and days since each appointment was last confirmed. Safe failure: Show 'owner not verified' and route the item to the sponsor without assigning responsibility.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: governance, HR, the assessment sponsor, control owners and records owners. Primary records: Approved RACI matrices, job descriptions, delegations, committee terms, control and evidence-owner registers, appointment records and corrective-action plans. Precedence: Current signed delegations and appointments outrank workflow defaults, directory labels and historic organisation charts. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect personal details; use role-level output by default. Flag expired appointments, unapproved delegation, orphan controls, conflicting accountable roles and actions assigned to inactive roles. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not assign accountability, assess an individual's performance or competence, disclose unnecessary personnel data, or treat a system role as proof that a duty was actually performed. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor plan interviews, obtain evidence from authorised owners and escalate gaps without misattributing responsibility.

AU-005

Material change

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which approved changes since the previous assessment could alter scope, applicability, risk, control operation or the evidence population?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Asset additions and removals, BMS or platform configuration events, meter and sensor commissioning, integration changes and registered zone changes may provide a factual delta signal. Coverage: In-scope sites, systems, assets, services and evidence channels, including changes that occurred after the previous cut-off but before the current period. Timing: Daily change summaries and event-level records for selected changes, compared with signed snapshots at both assessment cut-offs. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Unlogged manual changes, identifier reuse, delayed register updates and temporary project configurations can make apparent deltas incomplete or misleading. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Comparison + diagnosis - at planning, before sample selection and after any material change identified during fieldwork. Minimum evidence: Previous and current signed scope snapshots, exact cut-off dates, approved change records and current population registers. Method: Controlled baseline-to-current delta analysis and assessment-plan trigger check; classify changes by potential effect on scope, criterion, population, control design, evidence source or comparability; the assessor sets materiality. Uncertainty: Report changed-asset and changed-control percentages, unmatched change counts, effective-date gaps and changes known only from one source. Safe failure: List unverified changes and suspend trend or completeness claims for affected areas.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: change authorities, estates, IT, HR or governance, procurement and the scheme owner. Primary records: Approved change registers, project handover records, leases, organisation changes, supplier changes, incident records, prior scope and report, and scheme updates. Precedence: Approved change and handover records plus current owner confirmation outrank inferred differences in telemetry or file modification dates. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security-sensitive change details. Flag changes without approval, changes effective outside the recorded date, and conflicts between prior baselines, current registers and operational observations. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not decide materiality, infer an authorised change from telemetry alone, or assume that no detected technical delta means no organisational or procedural change occurred. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Allows the assessor to revise scope, testing and sample design before relying on an obsolete plan.

AU-006

Third-party boundary

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which landlord, utility, supplier, maintenance, cloud or shared services fall inside the boundary, and where does evidence responsibility transfer?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Service-interface availability, work-order and invoice receipt status, SLA measurement feeds, meter boundaries and integration logs may corroborate service delivery interfaces. Coverage: Every contracted or shared service that operates an in-scope control, creates evidence or can affect the assessment population, including known subcontractors. Timing: Native event timing with daily or monthly service summaries aligned to the contract reporting period. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Provider-defined metrics, inaccessible subcontractor systems, service credits, manual uploads and mismatched SLA clocks can conceal gaps or change definitions. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at scoping, contract change, supplier substitution and before relying on third-party assurance. Minimum evidence: Current contract and service scope, control allocation, named owners, data rights, reporting period, subcontractors and any assurance report with exact coverage and exceptions. Method: Service-control boundary and evidence-reliance map; decompose provider and customer responsibilities and map each interface to locally testable evidence and third-party evidence. Uncertainty: Report the percentage of outsourced controls with clear allocation, uncovered carve-outs, expired assurance days and services without evidence access. Safe failure: Mark the service reliance unverified and request owner or third-party evidence.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: procurement, legal, contract managers and suppliers. Primary records: Signed contracts, schedules, SLAs, data-processing and confidentiality terms, landlord-tenant responsibility matrices, supplier certifications, subcontractor lists and right-to-audit clauses. Precedence: Scheme requirements and signed contractual allocation for the relevant period outrank supplier dashboards, marketing claims and generic certificates. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Use only evidence the organisation is entitled to share. Flag expired certificates, excluded services, subcontractors not listed, audit rights not exercisable and differences between contractual and operational measures. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not treat a supplier certificate as proof that the local service operated effectively, access provider data without contractual authority, or decide whether reliance is sufficient. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor see where direct testing, contractual clarification or independent third-party evidence is required.

AU-007

Requirement precedence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Where legal, scheme, contractual and internal requirements overlap or conflict, what competent authorised interpretation applies for the relevant period?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: rule comparison can flag different thresholds, frequencies, retention periods or approval routes configured across systems. Coverage: In-scope criterion and control settings where two or more requirement sources govern the same activity or evidence. Timing: Event-driven on requirement or configuration change, with a quarterly unresolved-conflict summary. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Different units, jurisdictions, exceptions, transition dates and local implementation language can create false conflicts or conceal real ones. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning and whenever a conflicting requirement, exception, jurisdiction or transition rule changes. Minimum evidence: Exact requirement texts or authorised references, jurisdiction, effective dates, affected control and a recorded competent interpretation or escalation owner. Method: Requirement-conflict matrix and authorised-resolution trace; compare obligation, scope, threshold, frequency and evidence requirement; record resolved, partially resolved or unresolved without choosing a side. Uncertainty: Quantify unresolved conflicts, affected controls and days since escalation; distinguish text unavailable under licence from genuinely absent authority. Safe failure: Show 'authorised precedence not established' and prevent automated criterion mapping.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: legal, compliance, the scheme owner, contract owners and document control. Primary records: The legal register, scheme and accreditation rules, contracts, controlled policies, approved legal advice and formal technical interpretations. Precedence: Precedence must come from the competent authorised interpretation for the applicable jurisdiction and period; the service must not impose a universal hierarchy. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Limit privileged or licensed material. Preserve the exact conflicting clauses and interpretations, flag unresolved jurisdiction or effective-date questions, and do not collapse them into a single rule. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not provide legal advice, create an interpretation, apply privileged advice beyond authority, or configure a system to one requirement while a conflict remains unresolved. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to identify matters needing legal, scheme or contractual clarification before testing.

AU-008

Shared and inherited controls

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each local, shared or inherited control, who operates, monitors and evidences each component, and what must be tested within this unit?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Local device states, central-service availability, interface transaction counts and boundary health events may show whether a shared service was technically present at the consuming site. Coverage: Interfaces between local operations and central estates, IT, safety, security, finance or other providers for every inherited control in scope. Timing: Five-minute health aggregated daily, plus event-level failures and a configuration snapshot for selected assessment dates. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: A healthy shared service does not prove the local user configured, monitored or responded correctly; central dashboards may omit local carve-outs. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning, before reliance on inherited evidence and after any provider or interface change. Minimum evidence: Current control design, provider and consumer duties, dependencies, evidence sources, applicable period and exceptions or carve-outs. Method: Control decomposition and provider-consumer testing map; split each control into provider operation, local configuration, local use, monitoring and response; identify the evidence and procedure for each part. Uncertainty: Report responsibility coverage, untested interfaces, assurance-period gaps and the proportion supported only by provider assertion. Safe failure: Treat any uncovered responsibility as an assessment gap rather than assuming inheritance.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the local control owner and central or third-party service owner. Primary records: Control catalogues, statements of applicability, service descriptions, central assurance reports, MOUs, SLAs, responsibility matrices and local procedures. Precedence: Signed control allocation and the exact scope and period of any independent assurance report outrank inherited-control labels in local systems. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict central security detail. Flag assurance carve-outs, user-control considerations, expired coverage, local responsibilities without evidence and interfaces claimed by neither owner. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not double-count a shared control, rely on a central assurance report beyond its scope or period, or assume that technical availability proves effective local operation. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents both duplicate testing and hidden gaps at the boundary between local and shared services.

AU-009

Fieldwork evidence readiness

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

At fieldwork start, which criteria have authorised, current, retrievable and quality-qualified evidence, and which remain technically untestable?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Connector health, last successful export, document-index completeness and expected-versus-observed record counts may show whether candidate sources are accessible and producing data. Coverage: Every planned criterion test and its primary and corroborative evidence channels, without reading restricted content until permission is confirmed. Timing: Five-minute source health summarised daily, plus a readiness snapshot at agreed planning milestones. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A reachable system may contain incomplete or unauthorised evidence; a failed connector may not mean the authoritative record is unavailable through another route. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning milestones, one week before fieldwork and when a critical source changes state. Minimum evidence: For each planned test: criterion, assertion, population, one authoritative candidate source, owner, permission, required period, retrieval route and known limitation. Method: Evidence-readiness classification, explicitly separate from conformity; classify ready, partially ready, unavailable or unverified and show the precise failed gate. Uncertainty: Report ready-test percentage by category, population coverage, source age, export success rate and unresolved access count. Safe failure: Mark the test untestable and request evidence; do not infer a negative or positive result.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the audit liaison, assessor and each authoritative source owner. Primary records: The evidence request list, clause and control mapping, source-owner confirmations, access approvals, retention schedules and planned test procedures. Precedence: Controlled source availability and owner-approved access outrank automated connector status and self-declared readiness. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Expose only metadata before access approval. Flag sources with no owner, no permission, incomplete period, expired retention, untested export or conflicting readiness statements. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not present readiness as compliance, evidence sufficiency or likely certification outcome, and must not access content before authority is established. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports realistic fieldwork scheduling and early evidence requests while preserving assessor independence.

AU-010

Assumptions and dependencies

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which stated assumptions, dependencies, outages, projects or future changes could invalidate the planned population, sample, procedure or interpretation?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Source-health trends, planned outage feeds, commissioning status, time-synchronisation health and approved closure or project flags can indicate whether technical dependencies remain available. Coverage: Critical evidence systems, building services, contracted interfaces and planned observation locations. Timing: Daily during planning and fieldwork, with event-driven alerts for authorised outage, change or commissioning notices. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Unannounced works, permission changes, weather, timetable shifts and manual dependencies may not appear in telemetry; predicted availability is not a guarantee. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Forecast + scenario comparison - at planning, before sample freeze and whenever a trigger or dependency changes. Minimum evidence: Each material assumption stated testably with an owner, supporting evidence, validity period, trigger, affected procedure and contingency. Method: Assumption register, trigger monitoring and sensitivity analysis; run assessor-approved scenarios for loss of source, changed population, delayed access or atypical conditions; do not assign probabilities without evidence. Uncertainty: Report open assumption count, days to expiry, affected sample fraction and scenario ranges; label probability as unknown unless an authoritative estimate exists. Safe failure: Pause the affected test and show the contingency decision needed.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the sponsor, estates, IT, suppliers and relevant competent professionals. Primary records: The assessment plan, assumption and risk log, project and outage calendars, change freeze, dependency contracts, owner attestations and current access or closure notices. Precedence: Current authorised notices and owner confirmations outrank forecasts, historical schedules, telemetry inference and the May 2021 plan. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Record each assumption owner, evidence, expiry, trigger and consequence. Flag assumptions without current confirmation, dependencies outside contractual control and conflicting outage or access notices. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not predict a closure, hazard, service state or evidence outcome, accept a risk on the assessor's behalf, or fill an unverified dependency with a plausible assumption. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Makes the plan resilient and identifies when rescoping, resampling or qualified reporting may be necessary.

AU-011

Evidence-to-assertion map

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each criterion and assertion, which source supports it, over what population and period, and what claim remains unsupported?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: source registry can expose sensor modality, record type, spatial and asset coverage, granularity, last contact and health, linked to assessor-defined assertions. Coverage: In-scope criteria and planned tests, including primary records, corroborative telemetry, observations and management representations. Timing: Registry changes are event-driven; health is sampled every five minutes and summarised daily by source and assertion. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A source may be precise but irrelevant to the assertion, cover only part of the population or measure a proxy rather than the required control outcome. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - during test design and whenever a source, criterion or assertion changes. Minimum evidence: For every assertion: criterion, population, period, source owner, source type, provenance, coverage, limitation and planned corroboration. Method: Evidence-to-assertion coverage matrix; classify each source as directly supporting, partially supporting, contextual, contradictory or not relevant; retain negative capability statements. Uncertainty: Report assertions with zero, one or multiple independent sources, population and period coverage percentages, and unresolved source-purpose mismatches. Safe failure: Mark the assertion untestable where no authorised relevant source exists.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, records authority, control owners and system owners. Primary records: The evidence catalogue, source manuals and data dictionaries, control procedures, prior test plans and source-owner statements. Precedence: Authoritative controlled records for the relevant assertion and period outrank corroborative telemetry, convenience exports and historical references. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Record permitted purpose and audience for every source. Flag unclear system-of-record status, proxy measures, changed definitions, overlapping sources and claims that exceed documented source capability. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not declare a source sufficient or reliable merely because it exists, and must not stretch a proxy beyond the assertion it can physically or procedurally support. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor design proportionate procedures and target corroboration where evidence is weak or indirect.

AU-012

Evidence status

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which items are authoritative records, independent corroboration, management representation, context, calculated output or unverified proposed telemetry?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Source registration, digital signatures, system-of-record tags, device commissioning status and independent-source identifiers may provide metadata for evidence classification. Coverage: Every item offered for assessment, including documents, extracts, observations, representations and sensor-derived summaries. Timing: At ingestion and whenever provenance, owner designation or verification status changes; aggregate by evidence class for reporting. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Self-labelling by a system owner, a signature without trust validation or a healthy sensor does not by itself establish authority or independence. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at intake, before test execution and at report finalisation. Minimum evidence: For each item: origin, owner, system-of-record designation, collection method, control environment, independence, verification state and permitted use. Method: Evidence-status classification based on provenance, control and independence; apply assessor-approved classification rules without considering whether the content is favourable; preserve the original class and any later reclassification. Uncertainty: Report unclassified percentage, items whose status depends on management assertion, and verified-versus-proposed telemetry counts. Safe failure: Keep the item 'status unverified' and exclude it from direct-support claims.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: records management, compliance, the evidence owner and assessor. Primary records: The records-authority register, approved systems-of-record list, evidence classification policy, management representation letters and source-control documentation. Precedence: A current owner-designated authoritative record with verified controls outranks corroborative sources; management representation and proposed telemetry remain explicitly separate classes. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Limit management statements and personal data to authorised users. Flag items with unknown owner, unsigned representation, unverified signature, mixed source classes or a classification changed after check. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not upgrade telemetry or a management statement to authoritative evidence, infer independence from organisational distance, or hide the evidential class in a combined summary. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to weight evidence appropriately and identify where independent corroboration is still needed.

AU-013

Point-in-time currency

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Was each item effective, observed and technically available when the sampled event occurred, and what fraction of the required period does it cover?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Document effective dates, log start and end times, event timestamps, device clock-health indicators and data-gap markers may support point-in-time alignment. Coverage: Every sampled activity, criterion version, control record, proposed telemetry source and supporting document across the assessment period. Timing: Native event resolution retained; daily coverage summaries with UTC-normalised boundaries and explicit daylight-saving conversion. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Retrieval time can be mistaken for event time; late uploads, clock drift, back-dated approvals, changed time zones and overwritten configurations can misstate currency. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + temporal comparison - for each sampled event and at assessment-period close. Minimum evidence: Unique event and evidence IDs, effective and observed timestamps, source timezone, retrieval time, version history and gap indicators. Method: Temporal validity join and period-coverage calculation; join evidence only where its validity interval intersects the sampled event or declared test period; distinguish contemporaneous from retrospective evidence. Uncertainty: Report period coverage percentage, longest uncovered interval, maximum clock offset, age at retrieval and number of events with ambiguous temporal order. Safe failure: Exclude temporally unverified items from direct support and show the uncovered interval.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: document control, system owners, engineering and evidence custodians. Primary records: Controlled documents and histories, source logs, calibration and commissioning records, change records and authoritative event records. Precedence: The version demonstrably effective at the event time and the source's original observed time outrank current copies, file modification dates and retrieval timestamps. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing effective-from/to dates, back-dated records, time-zone ambiguity, evidence created after the event without explanation and conflicts between source and receipt times. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not treat retrieval or file-modification time as proof of event time, apply a current document retroactively, or assume a late-created record is contemporaneous. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents stale or temporally misaligned evidence from being used in a sampled conclusion.

AU-014

Evidence permission

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Is collection, access, analysis, retention, transfer and disclosure of each evidence item authorised for this purpose and audience?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Permission metadata, access-decision logs, classification labels, redaction status and secure export controls may show how an evidence item may be handled without inspecting content prematurely. Coverage: All repositories, datasets, documents, images and telemetry proposed for internal check, external assessment, certification files or public summaries. Timing: Event-level access and disclosure decisions, with daily summaries by role, purpose and evidence class. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Inherited permissions, stale groups, broad administrator roles, copied files and missing classification labels can create apparent access that is not lawful or purpose-limited. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - before access, analysis, export, sharing, report drafting and retention expiry. Minimum evidence: A named owner, legal or contractual basis, authorised purpose, permitted recipients, data classification, retention rule and required safeguards for every evidence class. Method: Purpose-by-role-by-field permission matrix and disclosure gate; evaluate requested operation against the authorised matrix; deny by default when any dimension is unknown. Uncertainty: Report authorised-field percentage, items requiring redaction, permission age, denied or unresolved requests and residual re-identification risk where measured. Safe failure: Block the operation, record the reason and request owner or governance approval.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: legal, information governance, data owners and the assessor. Primary records: The engagement terms, data-protection and confidentiality agreements, privacy notices, contracts, role entitlements, consent where applicable, information-classification policy and owner approvals. Precedence: Applicable law, contract, scheme rules and current data-owner approval outrank technical ability to access or a prior engagement's permission. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Record purpose, recipient, fields, retention, transfer location and redaction basis. Flag unknown ownership, expired permission, purpose expansion, restricted third-party data and conflicting disclosure decisions. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not override an access decision, infer consent, disclose personal, research, security-sensitive or commercially confidential content, or retain evidence beyond authority. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Protects lawful and ethical evidence handling while making permission gaps visible early.

AU-015

Provenance and lineage

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can every source-to-output path be reconstructed through extraction, transformation, joining, filtering, aggregation and presentation steps?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Source sequence numbers, extraction and query IDs, file hashes, ETL job logs, calibration metadata and transformation checkpoints can record technical lineage. Coverage: All primary records, proposed telemetry streams, manual uploads, calculated fields, joins, filters, visualisations and exported packages used in testing. Timing: Event-level lineage captured at collection and every transformation; daily completeness checks for broken links. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Manual spreadsheet edits, copy-and-paste, mutable queries, undocumented unit conversion and reprocessed sensor data can break or obscure provenance. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + reproduction - at ingestion, after each transformation and before any analytical result is cited. Minimum evidence: Source record IDs, tool and code version, parameters, operator or service role, timestamps, input and output hashes, unit and schema versions for every step. Method: End-to-end lineage graph and transformation completeness check; build a directed acyclic lineage graph from original evidence to report output and verify that every edge has a documented operation. Uncertainty: Report lineage coverage percentage, orphan inputs or outputs, undocumented-step count and hash mismatches. Safe failure: Withhold the affected result from direct support and expose the broken lineage point.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: data and system owners, analysts, records management and the evidence custodian. Primary records: Source schemas and data dictionaries, extraction specifications, scripts, transformation approvals, report definitions and original records. Precedence: Original controlled source records and approved transformation specifications outrank derived extracts or presentation files. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict source code and sensitive schemas where necessary while retaining verifiable hashes and descriptions. Flag undocumented manual steps, orphan outputs, changed queries and conflicting lineage claims. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not alter originals, conceal a manual step, infer provenance from file location alone, or reconstruct missing lineage with unsupported assumptions. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Allows the assessor or checker to understand how evidence became a reported fact and where reliability may be limited.

AU-016

Telemetry fitness

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each proposed telemetry source, are modality, placement, mapping, commissioning, calibration, clock alignment and current data health verified for the claimed use?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Device self-tests, last contact, expected and received samples, gateway loss, clock offset, calibration state and configuration checksum. Coverage: Every proposed device, gateway, meter, API and virtual sensor linked to an assertion, including the path from sensing point to stored record. Timing: Five-minute health, native samples, daily uptime and gaps, plus event-level commissioning, calibration and configuration changes. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Self-tests cannot reveal poor placement, wrong mapping, between-calibration drift, wiring error or upstream transformation faults. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + calculation + diagnosis - before first use, for each sampled period and after relocation, calibration, firmware or configuration change. Minimum evidence: 100% unique asset and location mapping, current commissioning, calibration within the approved interval, at least 95% expected samples unless another gate is approved, and clock skew within tolerance. Method: Sensor fitness gate for the specific evidential claim; verify the measurement chain, expected versus observed counts, quality flags, calibration and aggregation uncertainty. Uncertainty: Report uptime, missing percentage, maximum gap, clock skew, calibration uncertainty and mapping confidence. Safe failure: Keep the stream proposed or unfit and exclude it from verified corroboration.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: estates engineering, metering, platform and relevant competent professionals. Primary records: Commissioning and acceptance records, current asset and location mapping, calibration certificates, maintenance history, data dictionary, firmware and configuration register. Precedence: Current independently verified commissioning, mapping and calibration records outrank device self-report and plausible signal shape. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict detailed device locations where security-sensitive. Flag expired calibration, undocumented relocation, clock changes, firmware drift, missing health periods and conflicts between physical labels and registry. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer fitness from data presence, certify accuracy, fill gaps from an unhealthy stream, or generalise one calibrated device to an unmeasured population. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to decide whether proposed telemetry is fit to corroborate a specific test and what caveat is required.

AU-017

Source conflict

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Where authoritative records, assessor observations and telemetry disagree, what values, assets, locations and times conflict, and who may resolve them?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: A discrepancy detector can align readings, state changes and record attributes by asset, location and time, retaining each source's raw value and quality flags. Coverage: Only sources already authorised and mapped to the same assertion, asset and period; no cross-person behavioural matching. Timing: Native event timing with an assessor-approved alignment window; daily conflict summaries and event-level drill-down. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Different definitions, units, clocks, aggregation, manual corrections and delayed system updates can create apparent disagreement without a substantive control conflict. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Comparison + diagnosis - when a conflict is detected and before the affected fact is used in testing or reporting. Minimum evidence: At least two original source items, shared asset/assertion mapping, definitions, units, effective and observed times, quality status and named resolution owner. Method: Conflict preservation, normalisation and resolution-status tracking; compare like with like, classify definitional, temporal, measurement, transcription or substantive conflict, and record the authorised resolution separately. Uncertainty: Report conflict count, magnitude and duration, unresolved percentage, alignment tolerance and sensitivity of the result to each source. Safe failure: Present both sources, label the fact unresolved and stop dependent conclusions.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: each source owner, the audit liaison and the assessor. Primary records: All competing original records, data dictionaries, correction logs, source-precedence decisions and owner responses. Precedence: A formally designated authoritative source for the assertion and period may guide reliance, but the conflicting original must remain visible and resolution must be authorised. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive source details. Flag unresolved unit or identity mapping, back-dated corrections, owner disagreement and any attempt to replace rather than supersede an original. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not choose the favourable source, overwrite a conflicting original, infer that one owner is wrong, or present an unresolved reconciliation as a settled fact. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Directs follow-up to the right owner and makes any reporting qualification traceable.

AU-018

Evidence gaps

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which required periods, assets, locations, criteria or record classes have missing, partial or quality-excluded evidence?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Expected-versus-received record counts, connector uptime, device and register coverage, archive manifests and gap flags can identify technical absence. Coverage: The frozen in-scope population and all evidence classes required by the assessor's test plan, broken down by asset, zone, period and source. Timing: Five-minute source health, daily completeness metrics and a final period-end snapshot before sample or report closure. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: An empty result can mean no event occurred, no record was required, access was denied, retention expired or collection failed; these states must remain distinct. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation - before sample selection, after fieldwork and before report finalisation. Minimum evidence: A frozen population, expected record class and frequency, required period, source manifest and explicit reason code for every absence. Method: Multidimensional completeness matrix and gap-duration analysis; compare expected and available items by criterion, source, asset, location and time; do not impute absent values. Uncertainty: Report coverage percentage by stratum, longest gap, missing-record count, inaccessible fraction and unknown-status count. Safe failure: Show the affected population and limitation, and mark the test untestable where the minimum evidence is absent.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, audit liaison, records manager and source owners. Primary records: The evidence request list, scope and population registers, retention schedule, source manifests, access decisions and test plan. Precedence: The assessor-approved expected population and schedule plus authoritative source manifests outrank dashboard expectations or assumed event frequency. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag inaccessible, not-required, not-generated, deleted, expired-retention and technically missing as separate statuses. Preserve owner explanations and contrary evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not fabricate or statistically impute audit evidence, treat every absence as a control failure, or hide inaccessible and not-required states inside a single missing category. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables defensible resampling, alternative procedures and transparent limitation wording.

AU-019

Stable evidence export

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can each authorised evidence item be exported in a stable, readable form while preserving context, metadata, identifiers and a link to the source?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Export job IDs, schema versions, record counts, file hashes, attachment manifests and format validation may show whether a check copy matches the authorised source extract. Coverage: Every sampled record, telemetry extract, image, attachment, log and calculated output intended for assessor check or external handover. Timing: At each export, with immutable manifest and a validation rerun before handover; no periodic re-export without version change. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: CSV or PDF flattening can lose units, time zones, hidden rows, formulas, links, quality flags, signatures or attachments; proprietary viewers may be needed. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - at first export, after source or schema change, and immediately before external transfer. Minimum evidence: For each sampled item, a native or authoritative snapshot, check copy, data dictionary, record-count and attachment manifest, source pointer and cryptographic hash. Method: Export-import and semantic export validation; compare identifiers, fields, units, time zones, values, order-independent counts, attachments and links; open the check copy in the intended viewer. Uncertainty: Report omitted-field and attachment counts, record-count delta, hash status, truncation and any representation change that can alter interpretation. Safe failure: Withhold the export and provide the native access route or a documented limitation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: system owners, records management and the evidence custodian. Primary records: Native source files or snapshots, export specification, data dictionary, approved viewer, schema and attachment definitions, and the evidence manifest. Precedence: The native controlled record and its authorised metadata outrank the convenience check format. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Respect licence and security restrictions. Flag lossy formats, truncated fields, changed sort order, missing attachments, broken links and exports whose record count or hash differs from the manifest. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not circumvent a licence, strip caveats or provenance, convert a restricted native record into an unauthorised distributable copy, or claim semantic equivalence after a lossy export. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Gives the assessor a stable package that can be checked outside the source system without losing evidential meaning.

AU-020

Chain of custody

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can custody be traced from collection through copying, transformation, storage, redaction, transfer and external receipt?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Secure-transfer events, access and export logs, file hashes, sealed-package timestamps and receipt acknowledgements may support a custody timeline at user-role and file level. Coverage: Every evidence package, source snapshot and transformed copy collected for fieldwork, check, certification decision or archive. Timing: Event-level at acquisition, copy, transformation, transfer, receipt, access and disposal; daily checks for unexplained custody gaps. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Shared folders, offline copies, clock mismatch, administrator access, unlogged downloads and regenerated files can prevent a complete custody claim. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + sequence comparison - at collection, every transfer or transformation, and before closure or archival. Minimum evidence: Hash at acquisition and handover, unique package ID, authorised sender and recipient, purpose, timestamps, manifest, storage location and every transformation link. Method: Chronological chain-of-custody reconstruction and integrity check; build a custody timeline, verify hashes and permissions at each transition, and distinguish access from possession and transformation. Uncertainty: Report unlogged transitions, unexplained hash differences, custody-gap duration, clock tolerance and number of copies outside the approved register. Safe failure: Label custody incomplete and prevent an unqualified integrity statement.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the evidence custodian, records management, information security and assessor. Primary records: The evidence-handling procedure, custody register, transfer receipts, access logs, package manifests, incident records and approved recipient list. Precedence: Original signed custody records and trusted platform logs for the relevant event outrank informal email statements or file timestamps. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict recipient and security detail to need-to-know roles. Flag hash changes, missing receipts, unknown copies, clock discrepancies, transfers outside approved channels and custody records created retrospectively. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not claim forensic or tamper-proof integrity beyond verified controls, expose security architecture unnecessarily, or silently replace an unlogged transition with a reconstructed assumption. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports challenge, external check and investigation of any evidence-integrity concern.

AU-021

Current population

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

At the population-freeze time, do current asset, system, control and record populations reconcile to the approved boundary without duplicates or orphans?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Discoverable asset heartbeats, meter IDs, CMMS tags, gateway registrations and control-system endpoints may corroborate the existence of registered assets, but discovery is not exhaustive. Coverage: In-scope physical and digital assets, metering points, sensors, control panels and relevant control records. Timing: Fifteen-minute health aggregated daily, plus frozen inventory snapshots at scope approval and sample selection. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Offline, non-networked, seasonal, spare and retired assets may be absent; virtual or duplicate identifiers may inflate the population; location mapping may be stale. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - at scoping, before sample freeze and after any material asset or control change. Minimum evidence: For every sampled or high-risk asset: unique ID, class, current status, location, owner, control link and effective date; plus the signed boundary. Method: Population reconciliation and referential-integrity analysis; compare authoritative registers, selected field observations and verified telemetry registration; classify matched, unmatched, duplicate, retired or unresolved. Uncertainty: Report mapped-population percentage, duplicate and orphan counts, unverified-location percentage and change since the last verified snapshot. Safe failure: Use the authoritative register population with disclosed gaps, or mark the population not verified.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: estates asset management, IT asset management, control owners and records management. Primary records: The current approved asset and control registers, commissioning and handover records, controlled drawings, relocation and decommission logs. Precedence: The current owner-approved register and direct assessor verification outrank network discovery, telemetry presence and the May 2021 floor plan. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive asset locations. Flag duplicate or reused IDs, missing owners, assets present only in one source, status conflicts and current locations not supported by controlled records. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer completeness from network discovery, treat the May 2021 plan as current, or add, retire or relocate an asset in the authoritative register. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Establishes a defensible population for asset and control sampling.

AU-022

Critical designation

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which assets, services and controls are formally designated critical, under what approved basis, and when was that designation last validated?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Dependency links, service availability, alarm history and supported-load or area tags may provide context about operational significance without calculating criticality. Coverage: In-scope assets, services and controls designated critical or supporting a critical dependency. Timing: Daily service summaries, event-level outages and a point-in-time designation snapshot for each sampled period. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: High usage, frequent alarms or network centrality do not establish safety, business or compliance criticality; hidden manual dependencies may be absent. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning, after BIA or risk check, and after major asset or service change. Minimum evidence: For each designated item: unique ID, rationale, category, approval, effective date, owner, dependencies and required control or maintenance regime. Method: Designation-to-asset and dependency consistency check; map designations to current assets and controls and identify unclassified dependencies; do not generate an independent criticality score. Uncertainty: Report designated-population coverage, unclassified dependency count, expired-check days and conflicts between asset, risk and service registers. Safe failure: Label the designation unverified and refer it to the competent owner.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: business continuity, risk, estates, IT and relevant competent control owners. Primary records: The approved critical-asset register, business impact analysis, risk assessment, maintenance strategy, service maps and designation approvals. Precedence: The current approved designation and rationale for the relevant period outrank analytics-derived rankings and informal labels. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security-sensitive dependency maps. Flag unapproved designations, critical assets with no owner, conflicting criticality classes and dependencies missing from the current register. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not assign criticality, make a safety or business-impact judgement, accept risk, or reveal sensitive dependency details beyond authorised need. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor prioritise sampling and verify that enhanced controls apply to the intended population.

AU-023

Asset-record linkage

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can each maintenance, inspection, calibration or statutory record be tied to the correct physical asset, current location and due cycle?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: QR, barcode or NFC scan events, work-order asset IDs, instrument test events and device serial numbers may corroborate the asset identity used when work was recorded. Coverage: In-scope maintainable or testable assets and assessor-selected records; no continuous worker location tracking. Timing: Event-level at task start, result capture and closure, with monthly linkage-completeness summaries by asset class. Verification: Verify label-to-asset mapping, scanner identity/clock, scan provenance, duplicates and spot-check accuracy; no person-linked movement history. Limits: A scan proves only that an identifier was read; labels can be moved, serials mistyped, locations stale and offline paper records uploaded later. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - for each assessor-selected record and at period-end completeness check. Minimum evidence: Unique asset ID and serial, current location, task type, required and performed dates, result, competent performer or role, checker and source record ID. Method: Referential-integrity and due-cycle linkage test; join records to the asset population and approved schedule, then verify a selected sample against direct observation or authoritative label evidence. Uncertainty: Require 100% linkage for sampled items; report unmatched and duplicate percentages, due-date variance and location mismatch rate. Safe failure: Mark the record-to-asset link unverified and exclude it from that asset's test.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: maintenance or engineering, competent professionals, contract managers and records management. Primary records: The CMMS, statutory and inspection certificates, calibration records, test schedules, current asset register and contractor evidence. Precedence: The current asset register and signed competent-person record for the relevant task outrank telemetry identity and work-order summary fields. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Limit contractor and personnel details. Flag unmatched serials, reused work orders, missing due-cycle reference, records linked after closure and differences between physical label, certificate and register. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not conclude that work occurred or was satisfactory from a scan, heartbeat or status alone, and must not relabel or edit authoritative asset records. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents the assessor from testing a valid record against the wrong asset or due cycle.

AU-024

Control design record

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Is every in-scope control documented with an objective, trigger, method, frequency, evidence, dependencies, escalation route and accountable owner?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Read-only configuration snapshots, scheduled-job definitions and monitoring-channel registrations may corroborate that technical elements of a documented control are deployed. Coverage: In-scope preventive, detective and corrective control, including manual and outsourced components. Timing: Point-in-time at assessment planning and at each approved control-design change; daily status only for technical components. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Configured settings do not show approval, manual steps, competence, intended objective or whether the control design meets a criterion. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning and whenever a control objective, method, trigger, frequency, evidence or owner changes. Minimum evidence: A current approved design record for every in-scope control containing all required attributes and links to criterion, risk and evidence source. Method: Control-design completeness and internal-consistency check; check mandatory attributes, version consistency and traceable links; preserve assessor judgement on adequacy and suitability. Uncertainty: Report attribute-completeness percentage, missing or conflicting links, check age and controls supported only by draft documents. Safe failure: Mark the control design not documented for testing purposes and request the authoritative record.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: control owners, compliance, risk and document control. Primary records: The approved control catalogue, policies, procedures, risk treatments, statements of applicability, design approvals and RACI. Precedence: The current approved control design and criterion interpretation outrank observed configuration and informal practice descriptions. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing approval, superseded procedures, objectives with no evidence source, controls with no owner, and differences between controlled design and deployed configuration. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not design the control, decide that the design is adequate, convert observed practice into an approved procedure, or approve an undocumented local workaround. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor see which controls are sufficiently defined for operating-effectiveness testing and which need design evidence first.

AU-025

Required-record population

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For every required record class, what population should exist across in-scope assets, locations, processes and dates, and is that denominator complete?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Scheduled-task events, expected log volumes, source-manifest counts and connector availability may support an expected-versus-available record check. Coverage: All record classes required by criteria, control design or retention policy, partitioned by asset, process, location and assessment period. Timing: Native event capture with daily completeness summaries and a frozen period-end manifest. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: No-event periods, manually created records, batching, duplicate exports and changed schedules can make simple count comparison invalid. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - before sampling and at the end of the assessment period. Minimum evidence: Frozen populations, required record classes and frequencies, effective procedures, source manifests, exclusion rules and unique identifiers. Method: Expected-population reconstruction and completeness test; generate the expected record set, reconcile actual records and classify complete, duplicate, voided, missing, not required or inaccessible. Uncertainty: Report coverage percentage by record class and stratum, duplicate rate, longest gap and unknown-status count. Safe failure: Do not sample from an unverified population; report the limitation and request owner reconciliation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: records management, control owners and system owners. Primary records: The record-class register, retention schedule, control procedures, asset and process populations, document register and source manifests. Precedence: The assessor-approved expected population derived from current authoritative procedures and registers outranks assumed event frequency or dashboard count. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag changed schedules, duplicate or voided records, records outside the period, inaccessible archives and conflicts between required frequency and actual source design. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not generate missing records, assume a missing record proves control failure, or merge voided, duplicate and inaccessible states into a misleading completeness figure. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides a reliable denominator for record sampling and reveals where a population cannot be tested.

AU-026

Evidence-system access control

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are privileges to create, approve, administer, alter, export and retain evidence authorised, segregated and current for the sampled period?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Identity and role-assignment logs, administrative-event records, approval links and check timestamps may show current and historical privilege configuration without inspecting user content. Coverage: Accounts and service identities with create, approve, administer, delete, export or audit-log access to in-scope evidence systems. Timing: Event-level changes, daily privileged-access snapshots and check-cycle summaries by role; identity revealed only to authorised assessors. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Shared accounts, emergency access, nested groups, service identities and applications outside the central directory can evade a simple role check. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at each periodic check, for sampled access changes and at the assessment cut-off. Minimum evidence: Current account-role population, authoritative employment or contract status, approvals, role-risk rules, emergency-access history and check evidence. Method: Role entitlement, least-privilege and segregation-of-duties test; join accounts to authorised roles and test incompatible combinations, approval, expiry and check; the assessor defines the sample and significance. Uncertainty: Report orphan and excess-access percentages, incompatible-role count, days since check and removal latency for sampled leavers. Safe failure: Mark the entitlement unresolved and do not expose or change access.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: system owners, IAM or information security and HR. Primary records: IAM policy, role catalogue, approved access matrix, requests and approvals, HR joiner-mover-leaver records, privileged-access register and periodic check sign-offs. Precedence: Current approved entitlement and authoritative HR or contract status outrank directory membership alone. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect account and personnel detail. Flag orphan accounts, unapproved nested access, incompatible roles, expired temporary access, unreviewed privileges and conflicts between system and IAM records. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not disclose passwords or unnecessary personal activity, infer misconduct from privilege, revoke or provision access, or monitor attendance or productivity. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports targeted access-control testing while protecting sensitive identity and security information.

AU-027

Configuration baseline

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Did sampled system, meter and building-control configurations match the authorised point-in-time baseline and approved change history?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Read-only configuration snapshots, firmware and rule checksums, setpoints, alert routes and deployment events may show technical state at an assessor-selected time. Coverage: Only sampled in-scope systems, meters, controllers and monitoring rules; no write access or control commands. Timing: Event-level changes and daily snapshots where supported, with an immutable snapshot at each selected sample date. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Vendor defaults, hidden parameters, local overrides, unsupported legacy devices and snapshot timing can leave parts of the configuration unseen. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - for each assessor-selected snapshot and after a material change. Minimum evidence: Approved baseline, exact snapshot, authorised changes, effective times, tool coverage statement and asset identity. Method: Point-in-time configuration diff and authorised-change reconciliation; reconstruct the expected configuration at the sample date, compare each visible parameter and classify authorised, unauthorised, unknown or not observable. Uncertainty: Report changed-parameter count and percentage, unexplained changes, invisible parameters, clock tolerance and configuration age. Safe failure: Withhold a match claim where baseline, snapshot or tool coverage is incomplete.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: system or engineering owners and the change authority. Primary records: Approved baselines, engineering or vendor specifications, change tickets, test records, rollback records and configuration archives. Precedence: The approved point-in-time baseline plus authorised changes effective before the snapshot outrank the current running configuration as an approval record. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security-sensitive parameters. Flag snapshots with unknown tool coverage, changes without tickets, ticket dates after implementation and conflicts between archive and live state. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not alter settings, approve a configuration, declare a system safe or secure, infer intent from a deviation, or operate building or IT systems. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to identify configuration deviations for documentary and technical follow-up.

AU-028

Competence validity

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For sampled specialist or regulated work, were appointment, licence, training and approval valid for the task and date?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Work-order role tokens, credential-validity flags and task-approval events may corroborate temporal matching without continuous location or behaviour tracking. Coverage: Only assessor-selected tasks that require a defined appointment, licence, certification or competence; named identity is restricted to authorised check. Timing: Event-level at task performance and approval, with monthly aggregate counts by credential class. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A valid credential does not prove task quality; identity matching, subcontractor records, scope restrictions and suspended credentials may be incomplete. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - for each assessor-selected task and when a credential or appointment changes. Minimum evidence: Task performer and approver identity under restricted access, task type and date, credential scope, issuer, effective and expiry dates, appointment and required supervision. Method: Temporal credential-to-task and approval-authority match; match the task to valid credentials and authority at the event time; separate performance evidence from competence status. Uncertainty: Require 100% match for sampled identities; report expired, unmatched, scope-limited and unverifiable credentials plus days outside validity. Safe failure: Mark competence for the sampled task unverified and request authoritative confirmation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: HR, contract managers, competent-person registers and control owners. Primary records: HR or contractor competence matrices, appointment letters, licences, training and assessment records, scope restrictions and task records. Precedence: The authoritative credential issuer and current appointment record effective at the task time outrank a badge, directory title or self-declared skill. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Minimise personnel data and restrict sensitive records. Flag expired, suspended or out-of-scope credentials, missing issuer verification, task identities that do not match and approval by an unauthorised role. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer competence or performance from telemetry, disclose personnel records beyond need, make employment judgements, or validate a professional qualification itself. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor verify that selected specialist work was performed and approved by appropriately authorised people.

AU-029

Physical-digital identity

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Do assessor-observed physical labels, serials and locations reconcile to current registers, controlled drawings and telemetry identifiers?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Assessor-initiated barcode, QR or NFC scans, device serials and registered telemetry IDs may support spot reconciliation. Coverage: The assessor-selected sample of physical assets and their current stated locations. Timing: At the observation time, with no more frequent collection than the assessor's sample requires; aggregate mismatch results by asset class and zone. Verification: Verify label-to-asset mapping, scanner identity/clock, scan provenance, duplicates and spot-check accuracy; no person-linked movement history. Limits: Damaged or duplicated labels, inaccessible equipment, moved assets, similar serials and stale drawings can create false matches. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - during assessor-selected observation and after relocation or replacement. Minimum evidence: Observed identifier and location, current register entry, controlled drawing version, asset status and observation timestamp, with photo only where authorised. Method: Three-way physical label, register and drawing reconciliation; match unique identifiers and location hierarchy; classify exact, partial, conflicting or inaccessible. Uncertainty: Report mismatch rate, inaccessible fraction, ambiguous identifiers and drawing age; do not generalise from a convenience sample. Safe failure: Record the discrepancy and request owner verification; do not infer the current function of the room or asset.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: estates or IT asset management and document control. Primary records: The current approved asset register, controlled drawings, labelling standard, relocation records and commissioning documents. Precedence: Direct assessor observation plus current owner-approved registers and drawings outrank telemetry location, a historical plan and uncontrolled local labels. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive asset locations and images. Flag label-to-serial, serial-to-register and register-to-location conflicts, and retain the observed original without changing the register. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer current room use, access, service, hazard or closure from the May 2021 plan, disclose sensitive locations, or edit, move or relabel an asset. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Reduces the risk that evidence is attached to the wrong physical asset or location.

AU-030

Asset lifecycle continuity

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

When assets were moved, replaced, isolated, recommissioned or retired, were active controls transferred while prior evidence remained linked and retrievable?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Last-seen heartbeat, replacement-ID mapping, gateway reassignment and isolation-state events may provide lifecycle clues for networked assets. Coverage: In-scope assets with a lifecycle change during the assessment period and their predecessor, successor and control links. Timing: Event-level change capture and daily active-versus-retired summaries, with snapshots before and after the authorised lifecycle event. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: No heartbeat may mean outage rather than retirement; replacement identifiers can be reused; non-networked assets and archived records may not appear. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Sequence comparison - for every sampled lifecycle event and at the period-end population freeze. Minimum evidence: Old and new IDs, lifecycle state, effective date, approval, location, owner, control and maintenance links, disposal status and retained-record pointer. Method: Lifecycle-chain and control-reference continuity test; build predecessor-successor chains, test active references and verify that historical records remain immutable and discoverable. Uncertainty: Report orphan active IDs, broken links, conflicting status, days between physical and register change, and retained-history coverage. Safe failure: Treat lifecycle status as unresolved and exclude affected assets from completeness claims.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: estates, IT, engineering and records management. Primary records: Asset lifecycle and relocation records, decommission or isolation certificates, approved change tickets, disposal or transfer records, commissioning and archival links. Precedence: Approved lifecycle records and direct owner confirmation outrank last-seen telemetry and automatic discovery status. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag active controls pointing to retired assets, retired IDs still receiving records, broken predecessor-successor links, unapproved moves and records deleted before retention expiry. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not treat loss of telemetry as retirement, activate, isolate or decommission equipment, or delete, merge or rewrite historical asset records. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents testing the wrong active population while preserving traceability across replacement and retirement.

AU-031

Recurring control execution

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Across the defined population, did each sampled recurring control occur within its required window and leave complete, inspectable evidence?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Task-scheduler events, inspection-app submissions, test-instrument completion records, meter reads and work-order state changes may corroborate scheduled execution. Coverage: The assessor-selected recurring controls and the complete expected event population for the assessment period. Timing: Native event times retained; daily and monthly on-time summaries aligned to the approved schedule and time zone. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Automatic completion events, bulk closure, duplicate jobs, cancelled periods and manual evidence outside the system can distort counts and timing. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - for the full assessment period and at each assessor-selected sample date. Minimum evidence: Approved frequency and population, expected instances, unique completion and result records, checker where required, and authorised exclusions or cancellations. Method: Expected-schedule versus completed-instance test; generate expected instances, join actual events and classify on-time, late, missed, duplicate, cancelled or unverified; then inspect assessor-selected records substantively. Uncertainty: Report on-time percentage, missed and duplicate counts, lateness distribution, censored periods and record-linkage uncertainty. Safe failure: Do not infer operation where a result or required check is absent; mark the instance unverified.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: control owners, CMMS or workflow owners and competent checkers. Primary records: The approved control procedure and frequency, schedule, work orders or task records, results, check approvals and exception log. Precedence: The effective approved schedule and original task evidence outrank dashboard completion status. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag schedule changes without approval, completions lacking results, retrospective closure, duplicated tasks, cancelled instances and conflicts between task, check and exception records. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not treat a scheduler event or closed ticket as proof that the control was performed correctly, and must not decide whether frequency or quality satisfies the criterion. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides a complete operating population and directs substantive testing to missed, late and anomalous instances.

AU-032

Threshold response

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each sampled authorised threshold breach, did detection, alerting, acknowledgement, escalation, response and closure occur in the required sequence?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Verified temperature, CO₂, leak, power, plant and other approved threshold events, together with alarm creation, acknowledgement, escalation and clear states. Coverage: Only mapped in-scope assets and zones with an approved threshold and response procedure; no person-level exposure or behaviour tracking. Timing: Native one-minute or device resolution retained, event-level response timing and daily aggregate counts by asset or zone. Verification: Verify model/location, commissioning, calibration/reference check, sample interval, clock alignment, range checks, uptime/gaps, drift, firmware and lineage. Limits: Calibration uncertainty, averaging windows, hysteresis, suppressed alarms, clock skew and sensor placement can alter whether and when a threshold appears breached. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + sequence comparison - for every assessor-selected breach and for the complete breach population where available. Minimum evidence: Verified source fitness, current threshold and averaging rule, full alarm and response event chain, responsible role, escalation condition and closure evidence. Method: Event-to-response state and timing analysis; recompute threshold events from authorised raw data where permitted, align clocks and compare each required response state with actual timestamps. Uncertainty: Report breach duration, response and closure percentiles, missing-state count, clock tolerance, measurement uncertainty and unobserved intervals. Safe failure: Label the event or response unverified and refer safety interpretation to the competent owner.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: engineering, safety or environmental control owners and competent professionals. Primary records: The approved threshold register, current response and escalation procedure, alarm and ticket logs, closure evidence, calibration and mapping records. Precedence: Current authorised threshold and competent professional instruction outrank dashboard defaults or retrospective threshold changes. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive alarm and location details. Flag threshold-version mismatch, unapproved suppression, missing ticket linkage, clock inconsistency and closure without specified evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not set or change thresholds, diagnose a hazard, infer individual exposure, operate systems, or declare a safety or environmental requirement satisfied. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Allows the assessor to test whether the documented response control operated for selected threshold events.

AU-033

Inspection and test workflow

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Did sampled inspections and tests use the effective method, suitable calibrated instruments, required independence and complete exception retention?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Digital test-instrument results, inspection-app timestamps, asset scans and workflow state changes may corroborate the sequence and identity of a test record. Coverage: In-scope scheduled inspections and tests, with detailed access limited to the assessor-selected sample. Timing: Event-level at assignment, performance, result, check and closure; monthly coverage summaries by test class. Verification: Verify label-to-asset mapping, scanner identity/clock, scan provenance, duplicates and spot-check accuracy; no person-linked movement history. Limits: A timestamp or device result does not prove the correct method, competent judgement or physical coverage; offline and paper tests may be uploaded later. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + sequence comparison - for the assessment period and each selected inspection or test. Minimum evidence: Task and asset ID, required method/version, result and raw evidence, performer competence, check requirement, exception linkage and closure approval. Method: Inspection and test workflow-conformance analysis followed by assessor-selected substantive check; verify sequence, method version and required fields, then reconcile failed or conditional results to exceptions and actions. Uncertainty: Report completeness, late-check days, superseded-method count, unlinked failure rate and the proportion with original raw evidence. Safe failure: Mark the test instance unverified and retain any adverse result; do not substitute a summary.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the competent function, engineering, safety and records management. Primary records: The approved schedule and controlled checklist or method, original results and certificates, checker sign-off, competence records and linked exceptions or actions. Precedence: The current controlled method and signed competent-person result outrank workflow status or extracted summary. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect personnel and security-sensitive details. Flag use of superseded methods, missing raw results, checker conflict, post-dated signatures and failed items closed without retained exception evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not validate the professional inspection result, reinterpret a test outcome, hide a failed or conditional item, or substitute for a competent statutory inspection. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor select valid test records and identify workflow or evidence-integrity exceptions.

AU-034

Access lifecycle operation

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Did sampled joiner, mover, temporary and leaver access changes follow authorised request, approval, provisioning, periodic check, expiry and removal steps?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Identity-management and access-control configuration events may show account and role creation, change, expiry and removal. Coverage: The assessor-selected access-change population for in-scope evidence and control systems, including service and temporary accounts. Timing: Event-level workflow and configuration times, with weekly aggregates by change type and system. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Manual local accounts, delayed HR feeds, nested groups, emergency access and shared identities can make the central sequence incomplete. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Sequence comparison - for each assessor-selected joiner, mover, temporary and leaver case and at the period-end population check. Minimum evidence: Authoritative trigger, request, approvals, requested role, provisioning, check or expiry, removal, exception and exact timestamps for all affected systems. Method: Access lifecycle sequence, authority and timing test; compare the approved workflow to event order and elapsed time, including downstream and local systems. Uncertainty: Report exception percentage, median and maximum provisioning or removal time, missing downstream events and clock uncertainty. Safe failure: Mark the case incomplete and request target-system or owner evidence; do not infer compliant removal from one system.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: HR, IAM or information security and system owners. Primary records: Authoritative HR or contractor status, access requests, approvals, role catalogue, provisioning and removal logs, periodic checks and exception records. Precedence: Authoritative employment or contract trigger plus approved access request outrank system account timestamps alone. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict identities to the assessor's authorised sample. Flag missing approvals, out-of-sequence events, expired temporary access, accounts without an HR or contract anchor and conflicts between IAM and target systems. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not monitor attendance, infer misconduct, reveal unnecessary access history, approve an entitlement, or provision, revoke or suspend access. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports operating-effectiveness testing of access changes without using behavioural surveillance.

AU-035

Alert triage and escalation

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Were sampled alarms and monitoring exceptions generated, triaged, assigned, escalated, suppressed and closed under the effective procedure?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Alert creation, severity, acknowledgement, assignment, escalation, suppression and clear events may provide a state history by asset, system or zone. Coverage: The complete in-scope alert population, with detailed records for assessor-selected cases; no individual productivity or response-behaviour inference. Timing: Native event timing retained, daily volumes and weekly response-time distributions by alert class. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Alert storms, duplicate suppression, clock drift, auto-acknowledgement, rule changes and manual resolution outside the platform can distort workflow history. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Sequence comparison + calculation - for the full alert population and each assessor-selected alert. Minimum evidence: Alert and rule/version ID, complete event sequence, responsible role, required escalation conditions, linked ticket or incident and closure evidence. Method: Alert state-transition and response-timing analysis; reconstruct state transitions, test required sequence and calculate response, escalation and closure timing by alert class. Uncertainty: Report missing-state rate, response and closure percentiles, suppressed duration, duplicates, clock tolerance and alerts outside monitored periods. Safe failure: Mark the workflow unverified where the event chain is incomplete.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: monitoring, system and control owners. Primary records: The approved alert rules and severity matrix, on-call and escalation procedure, incident or ticket records, suppression approvals and closure evidence. Precedence: The rule and workflow version effective at alert creation plus original event records outrank current dashboard state. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security and personnel details. Flag unapproved suppression, missing state transitions, severity changed without authority, closure without evidence and conflicts between alert and ticket systems. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not reclassify severity, infer staff performance or blame, suppress or acknowledge alerts, or claim that closure proves the underlying control was effective. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Identifies alert cases for substantive check and exposes monitoring blind spots or workflow deviations.

AU-036

Utility data controls

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Did meter capture, estimation, validation, reconciliation, adjustment and approval controls operate for utility data used in billing or reporting?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Fiscal and submeter readings, pulse counts, gateway health, estimated-read flags and meter hierarchy may support consumption and data-quality reconciliation. Coverage: In-scope utility meters and reporting or billing periods, aggregated by meter, supply and day; no inference about individual activity. Timing: Native 15-minute or hourly readings retained, daily aggregates and billing-period snapshots. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Meter class and calibration, rollovers, multipliers, estimated reads, shared supplies, missing submetering and clock alignment can create reconciliation residuals. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + reconciliation - monthly or billing-period close and for assessor-selected meters and adjustments. Minimum evidence: Mapped meter hierarchy, complete period reads, meter quality status, supplier statement, approved calculation and every manual estimate or adjustment with authority. Method: Meter-population, consumption-balance and adjustment-control test; recalculate authorised totals and balances, identify gaps and residuals, and trace each estimate or adjustment through check and approval. Uncertainty: Report metered-population coverage, gap-filled percentage, balance residual and tolerance, adjustment value/count and measurement uncertainty. Safe failure: Show the period not reconciled and do not substitute an estimated total without explicit source status.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: energy or utilities, finance and the supplier. Primary records: The meter register, calibration and commissioning records, supplier statements, tariffs or contracts, reconciliation procedure, adjustment approvals and reporting definitions. Precedence: Supplier or fiscal records and owner-approved meter hierarchy for the relevant period outrank submeter dashboards and estimated analytics. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect commercially sensitive tariffs. Flag unmapped meters, changed multipliers, unapproved estimates or adjustments, billing-period mismatch and conflicts between fiscal and submeter totals. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not certify meter accuracy, approve a bill or adjustment, make a carbon or utility assurance claim, infer occupant behaviour, or operate a supply or meter. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to test controls over utility evidence used in financial, environmental or certification reporting.

AU-037

Contracted service evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For sampled contracted services, was the specified output delivered, independently checked, exceptions retained and acceptance completed before payment?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Work-order completion, area-level service confirmation, bin or plant status and exception tickets may corroborate delivery without tracking individual workers. Coverage: Assessor-selected services, locations, shifts or periods and the related contractual population; aggregates remain at service, area and time-window level. Timing: Event-level service records with daily or monthly SLA summaries aligned to the contract period. Verification: Verify model/location, commissioning, calibration/reference check, sample interval, clock alignment, range checks, uptime/gaps, drift, firmware and lineage. Limits: Presence or status signals cannot show service quality; self-reported supplier completion, batch uploads and inaccessible subcontractor data can bias evidence. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - at each contract check or payment cycle and for assessor-selected service instances. Minimum evidence: Contract requirement and period, scheduled instance, supplier evidence, independent client check or exception, acceptance decision and invoice or payment link. Method: Three-way requirement-delivery-acceptance and payment match; join the four stages and classify verified, partially evidenced, disputed, rejected or unverified; inspect selected cases substantively. Uncertainty: Report verified-service percentage, disputed and supplier-only counts, unverified payment value and timing differences between service, acceptance and invoice. Safe failure: Mark delivery unverified where independent acceptance evidence is absent.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: contract managers, procurement, finance, service users and suppliers. Primary records: The contract and SLA, schedules, service records, check sheets, exceptions, client acceptance, invoices and payment approvals. Precedence: Signed contract requirements and authorised client acceptance evidence outrank supplier dashboards or sensor proxies. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect worker and commercial information. Flag supplier-only evidence, missing client checks, service and invoice period mismatch, rejected work billed as accepted and subcontractor evidence without authority. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer worker productivity, identify staff unnecessarily, accept service, approve payment, or determine contractual breach or conformity. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports targeted testing of outsourced service and payment controls.

AU-038

Change-control sequence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For sampled changes, did request, impact assessment, approval, implementation, testing, rollback readiness and record update occur in the required order?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Configuration and deployment events, BMS setting snapshots, service health and downtime around changes may corroborate implementation timing and technical effect. Coverage: The assessor-selected changes affecting in-scope systems, controls, meters, assets or evidence sources; strictly read-only. Timing: Event-level before, during and after change, with daily summaries of changed assets and failed deployments. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Automated deployment logs may omit manual work, emergency changes, hidden parameters and post-change acceptance; uptime does not prove test success. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Sequence comparison - for each assessor-selected change and at period-end change-population check. Minimum evidence: Complete change record, exact timestamps, affected population, approvals, pre/post snapshots, test result, rollback evidence or rationale, and downstream record updates. Method: Change workflow sequence, authorisation and pre/post state test; reconstruct the expected sequence, compare technical state and identify missing or out-of-order steps. Uncertainty: Report missing-step rate, approval-to-implementation lag, unexplained parameter changes, failed-test count and time-alignment uncertainty. Safe failure: Mark the change control unverified and preserve the observed state without intervention.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: change authority and affected system or control owners. Primary records: Change requests, impact and risk assessments, approvals, implementation and rollback plans, test and acceptance records, configuration snapshots and updated asset or procedure records. Precedence: The approved change record and point-in-time configuration evidence outrank current-state assumptions. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security-sensitive detail. Flag implementation before approval, missing rollback or test evidence, emergency changes not retrospectively approved and records not updated after change. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not approve, implement or roll back a change, operate systems, infer success from availability alone, or decide whether an emergency change was justified. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor select changes with sequence or evidence anomalies for substantive check.

AU-039

Emergency preparedness evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Were required emergency checks, equipment tests and exercises completed for the approved population, with resulting actions linked to verified closure evidence?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Alarm-panel test events, emergency-light self-tests, refuge-call status, generator or UPS tests and authorised drill notification logs may corroborate scheduled activity at asset or system level. Coverage: In-scope emergency assets and assessor-selected drills or tests; no participant identification, movement tracking or evacuation-performance scoring. Timing: Native test events with monthly coverage, plus event-level records for failures and linked actions. Verification: Verify model/location, commissioning, calibration/reference check, sample interval, clock alignment, range checks, uptime/gaps, drift, firmware and lineage. Limits: Self-tests may not cover physical condition, route availability, human procedures or competent inspection; disabled devices and local paper records may be absent. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - at statutory or owner-defined intervals and for each assessor-selected drill, test or failed item. Minimum evidence: Defined asset or participant population, required schedule, authorised test or drill record, result, competent check, actions, due dates and retest or closure evidence. Method: Expected-versus-completed emergency-control test and action follow-through analysis; reconcile expected events and trace each adverse result to action and retest; separate asset self-test from professional inspection and drill evaluation. Uncertainty: Report population coverage, failed or overdue items, action ageing, retest completion and periods without verified monitoring. Safe failure: Refer the matter to the competent safety owner and do not state compliance or readiness.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: fire, safety, estates and other competent professionals. Primary records: Statutory and owner-approved schedules, competent-person reports, drill records, emergency plans, defect and action logs, maintenance and closure evidence. Precedence: Current legal or competent-professional requirements and signed test or drill records outrank device self-test summaries. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive emergency plans and participant data. Flag missing competent check, failed items without action, overdue retests, scope differences and plans not updated after change. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not declare fire, emergency or safety compliance, infer individual evacuation performance, replace a competent inspection, or activate alarms or emergency systems. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides an evidence map for safety-control testing while preserving professional and statutory authority.

AU-040

Monitoring blind spots

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

During which intervals were monitoring sources, rules, gateways or integrations blind, degraded, suppressed or misconfigured, and how was that limitation controlled?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Watchdog heartbeats, source inventory, queue lag, storage capacity, clock-sync status, suppression and configuration logs, and expected-versus-received sample counts. Coverage: The complete proposed monitoring chain from sensing point through gateway, integration, rule, alert, ticket and retained evidence store. Timing: Five-minute health, event-level suppression or configuration change, daily coverage summaries and period-end blind-spot inventory. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: A green dashboard can depend on the same failed component it is monitoring; partial-path failure, stale status, silent data corruption and approved maintenance windows can be missed. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Diagnosis + calculation - continuously for health, at every suppression or outage, and before reliance on any monitored control population. Minimum evidence: Expected source and rule inventory, complete health and suppression history, approved maintenance windows, incident or ticket evidence and restoration verification. Method: End-to-end monitoring coverage and blind-interval reconstruction; calculate path coverage, identify intervals where data or alerts could not be relied on and trace each interval to approved control or remediation. Uncertainty: Report source and path coverage, longest blind interval, unapproved suppression duration, queue or storage loss, and unknown-status percentage. Safe failure: Exclude affected periods and sources from control-effectiveness analysis.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: platform, telemetry, system and control owners. Primary records: Monitoring architecture and source inventory, approved health thresholds, suppression approvals, maintenance and incident tickets, outage windows and remediation evidence. Precedence: Independently verified source inventory and owner-approved health design outrank a single self-monitoring dashboard. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict security architecture. Flag unapproved or expired suppression, sources absent from monitoring, health checks that do not cover the full path, missing incident records and conflicts between watchdog and source evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not equate a green dashboard with control effectiveness, restore or enable monitoring, cancel a suppression, or conceal a blind period by interpolation. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor see whether telemetry and alert evidence can be relied on and where alternative procedures are necessary.

AU-041

Sampling population

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What exact, deduplicated and time-bounded population will the assessor use before selecting each sample?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Read-only identifiers and counts from asset, work-order, event, document and control systems may support a population snapshot without selecting the sample. Coverage: The entire assessor-defined population for the relevant criterion, period and inclusion rule, not only items visible through one connector. Timing: A single frozen extraction at sample selection, with change events retained separately and no silent refresh after the freeze. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Duplicate IDs, late records, inaccessible sources, changed status and query filters can make the extracted frame differ from the true authoritative population. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + calculation - immediately before each sample is selected and whenever the assessor authorises a new population. Minimum evidence: Approved criterion and assertion, inclusion and exclusion rules, exact period, source query, unique record IDs, extraction time, record count and package hash. Method: Population reconstruction, reconciliation and immutable freeze; run the authorised query, reconcile source counts, remove only documented duplicates and preserve the frozen frame plus all exclusions. Uncertainty: Report duplicate, unresolved and inaccessible percentages, source-count variance, late-arriving items and the proportion not covered by the extraction route. Safe failure: Do not generate a sample until the assessor accepts the documented population limitation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and each population source owner. Primary records: The signed scope, current authoritative registers, source-system query definitions, inclusion and exclusion rules, period cut-off and population change history. Precedence: The assessor-approved population definition and authoritative source records outrank telemetry discovery, convenience reports and local lists. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive identifiers. Flag duplicates, records added after freeze, inconsistent inclusion rules, inaccessible sub-populations and differences between source counts and the frozen manifest. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not choose the population, change inclusion rules, remove inconvenient items, select an undisclosed sample, or present a technically discoverable subset as complete. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Creates a defensible denominator and prevents sampling from an incomplete or shifting frame.

AU-042

Reproducible sample generation

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

After the assessor defines the population and rule, can random, systematic or stratified selection be reproduced from a preserved seed and population hash?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: sampling service can record the frozen population hash, algorithm, random seed, strata, ordered frame and selected identifiers. Coverage: Only the assessor-approved population and sampling design; source telemetry may supply eligible IDs but does not decide inclusion. Timing: One execution per authorised sample, with immutable execution time and any assessor-approved supplementary sample recorded separately. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Unstable row ordering, duplicate IDs, changing strata, non-random software functions and post-selection substitution can undermine reproducibility. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation - only after the assessor freezes the population and explicitly authorises the method, size and strata. Minimum evidence: Population hash, ordered frame or ordering rule, algorithm and version, seed, sample size, strata, inclusion probabilities and replacement rule if any. Method: Exact execution of an assessor-specified probability or systematic sampling rule; execute once, preserve all parameters and output, independently rerun to verify identical selection, and record supplementary selections as new events. Uncertainty: Report inclusion probabilities, achieved sample by stratum, duplicate selection count and exact reproducibility status. Safe failure: Stop if the population hash, ordering, algorithm or approval is missing or has changed.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and evidence custodian. Primary records: The assessor-approved sampling plan, frozen population manifest, strata definitions, sampling code or tool version and any permitted replacement rule. Precedence: The signed sampling plan and frozen population outrank software defaults or a previously used sample. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive selected identifiers until authorised disclosure. Flag seed reuse where inappropriate, population changes, undocumented substitutions, algorithm changes and samples produced before plan approval. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not determine sample size, method or strata, optimise for favourable results, conceal the seed, substitute selected items, or select any sample not disclosed to and controlled by the assessor. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides transparent, repeatable selection while keeping sampling judgement with the assessor.

AU-043

Sample coverage

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Does the selected sample achieve the assessor-defined coverage across locations, periods, asset types, owners, risk strata and exception status?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Sample metadata can be joined to verified asset, control, zone, period and status attributes to show achieved coverage without changing the selection. Coverage: The frozen population and selected sample across the exact assessor-defined strata; named people are not used as a behavioural stratum. Timing: At selection and after any authorised supplementary sample, with no continuous monitoring required. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Missing or stale population attributes, small strata and post-selection reclassification can make apparent coverage inaccurate. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - immediately after selection and before concluding fieldwork. Minimum evidence: Complete strata attributes for every population and sample item, target allocations, inclusion probabilities and any authorised supplement. Method: Achieved-stratum coverage and sampling-weight analysis; compare target and achieved counts, identify zero-cell or under-covered strata and calculate weights only for a valid probability design. Uncertainty: Report counts and percentages by stratum, coverage shortfalls, effective sample size and sampling error or confidence interval where assumptions permit. Safe failure: State that representativeness is not established and request assessor direction on supplementation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and the relevant population source owners. Primary records: The sampling plan, frozen population, current authoritative attribute registers and sample manifest. Precedence: The attributes effective at population freeze and the assessor's strata definition outrank current labels or inferred telemetry categories. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect sensitive location and owner information. Flag sample items with unknown strata, strata redefined after selection, empty cells and conflicts between asset, control and location registers. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not claim representativeness beyond the approved design, reclassify items to improve coverage, or add a hidden convenience sample. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to decide whether the sample needs supplementation or a limitation.

AU-044

Observation corroboration

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can each direct observation be time-aligned and corroborated with an independent record and, where fit, verified telemetry for the same asset or zone?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Asset state, environmental measurements, meter values, plant or door status and authorised area-level counts may provide time-bounded corroboration around an assessor observation. Coverage: Only the observed asset or zone and a narrow assessor-defined time window; no speech, network-content, facial, device or individual movement data. Timing: Native resolution retained for the observation window, with a clearly stated alignment tolerance and aggregated contextual summary. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Sensor placement, clock skew, aggregation, intermittent state and partial visibility can make a signal appear to contradict an observation. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - for each assessor-selected observation requiring corroboration. Minimum evidence: Observation timestamp and asset/location ID, at least one authoritative record, one independent verified source where available, source fitness and a declared alignment window. Method: Asset-time-location triangulation; normalise time and identity, compare states and values, and classify corroborating, neutral, conflicting or unavailable without averaging away disagreement. Uncertainty: Report alignment window, maximum clock skew, measurement uncertainty, source independence and the number of corroborating versus conflicting items. Safe failure: Use the direct observation with stated limitation and do not infer missing context.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and relevant system or asset owners. Primary records: The assessor's contemporaneous observation note, authorised photograph where permitted, current asset and location record, work orders, control logs and verified sensor mapping and health. Precedence: The assessor's direct observation and authoritative source record outrank inferred telemetry; telemetry remains corroborative unless independently verified for the exact use. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Apply strict observation and image permissions. Flag asset or time mismatch, inaccessible raw data, changed mapping, privacy risk and contradictions that owners have not resolved. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not identify occupants, record speech or images without authority, infer behaviour, replace the assessor's observation, or treat telemetry as proof of a human action. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Strengthens or challenges an observation while preserving privacy and evidential status.

AU-045

Telemetry representativeness

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Does verified deployment density, placement and uptime support the intended population inference, or is telemetry limited to an instrumented subset?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Verified deployment mapping, device type and placement, sampling rate, uptime, calibration and gateway coverage can describe the instrumented subset. Coverage: The full target population of assets, zones or systems and every proposed sensing point intended to support the assertion. Timing: Deployment snapshot at sample design, daily health distribution and period-level coverage by asset class or zone. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Convenience placement, clustered sensors, inaccessible areas, different device generations, changed room use and non-random failure can bias the instrumented subset. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Estimate + calculation - before any generalisation from telemetry and after material deployment or population change. Minimum evidence: Verified mapping for every proposed sensor, complete target population, placement rationale, sampling and health history, and assessor-defined representativeness dimensions. Method: Instrumented-population coverage and selection-bias assessment; calculate instrumented percentage by stratum, spatial or asset-class gaps, uptime distribution and differences between measured and unmeasured populations. Uncertainty: Report coverage percentages, concentration indices, missing strata and confidence limits only where placement supports probability inference. Safe failure: Restrict use to local corroboration and label population inference unsupported.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: estates, platform owners and competent engineering professionals. Primary records: The current authoritative asset and space population, commissioning and mapping records, sensing design rationale, calibration and health history. Precedence: Current verified mapping and population registers outrank the May 2021 floor plan, network location and assumed coverage radius. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict detailed sensor locations where necessary. Flag unmapped or moved devices, asset classes with no sensing, unequal uptime, changed population and design rationales not approved for the evidential use. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not generalise from a convenience deployment, infer current room use from the May 2021 plan, or claim that dense sensing removes sampling bias. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor see whether telemetry can support population-level analysis or only selected local observations.

AU-046

Atypical period

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are sampled dates materially affected by season, timetable, occupancy context, closures, projects, weather, shutdowns or abnormal demand?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Authorised weather data, utility load, plant mode, area-level occupancy counts, outage flags and project or closure status may provide non-identifying context. Coverage: The sampled period and one or more comparable periods using the same definitions, source mapping and aggregation; no individual attendance or productivity measures. Timing: Fifteen-minute or hourly operational data aggregated daily and weekly; event-level authorised outages and project phases retained. Verification: Verify asset/location mapping, commissioning, calibration or verification, interval/reset rules, clock alignment, expected/received records, uptime/gaps, drift, schema and raw lineage. Limits: Changed sensors, timetables, tariffs, plant settings, population and data gaps can look like real contextual difference or hide one. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Comparison + estimate - at sample design and before extrapolating a sampled operating result. Minimum evidence: Same-definition data for the sample and at least one justified comparable period, with source fitness, calendar, weather, outage and service-intensity context. Method: Context-normalised comparison and atypicality screening; compare distributions and percentiles, stratify by context and conduct sensitivity analysis excluding exceptional days; avoid causal attribution. Uncertainty: Report percentile position, standardised difference or range, comparable-period count, context coverage and effect of excluding abnormal intervals. Safe failure: State that typicality cannot be established and limit the inference to the observed period.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: timetabling, estates, energy, project and source owners. Primary records: The academic or operational calendar, authorised occupancy or service schedules, outage and project notices, weather station records and prior comparable-period data. Precedence: Current authorised calendars and notices plus comparable verified data outrank inferred occupancy or historical room assumptions. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect timetable and occupancy detail. Flag changed definitions, non-comparable sensor coverage, exceptional closure, missing baseline and conflicts between planned and actual service status. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer individual attendance, behaviour or productivity, declare the period representative automatically, or attribute a difference to one context factor without evidence. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to decide whether to extend the period, stratify the sample or qualify the conclusion.

AU-047

Outlier diagnosis

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each outlier, what evidence supports data error, a legitimate exceptional condition or a broader pattern, and what remains unexplained?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Raw and quality-flagged values, device health, neighbouring asset or zone signals and event metadata may support staged investigation without suppressing the outlier. Coverage: The affected source, peer group and historical window defined before diagnosis; no individual behaviour or protected-attribute data. Timing: Native event resolution retained, with 15-minute or daily summaries only after raw validation. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Peer assets may not be comparable; maintenance, calibration, unit changes, clipping, clock drift and genuine rare conditions can produce similar shapes. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Diagnosis + comparison - when an unusual result could affect sample selection, exception analysis or reporting. Minimum evidence: Raw data, source fitness, unit and timestamp definition, at least one independent contextual record and an assessor-approved peer or historical comparison. Method: Staged outlier validation and pattern assessment; first test data integrity and mapping, then compare robust statistics and recurrence across peers and time, preserving the original value. Uncertainty: Report robust z-score or percentile, recurrence count, peer-group size, missingness, calibration uncertainty and sensitivity to alternate peer definitions. Safe failure: Leave the item 'unresolved unusual result' and do not classify or remove it.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: source, asset, control and incident owners. Primary records: Incident, maintenance, calibration, configuration and change-event records, weather or service context, original records and related exceptions. Precedence: Original verified measurements and authoritative contextual records outrank a cleaned series or model label. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag corrected data, unit changes, missing raw values, model-generated imputations, peer-group changes and owner disagreements about the event explanation. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not suppress or winsorise an outlier without disclosure, classify it as a nonconformity or data error automatically, or infer root cause from correlation. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Focuses follow-up on the most plausible evidence gaps without prejudging the finding.

AU-048

Testability gate

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What claim-specific minimum evidence must be present before a sampled assertion is technically testable rather than merely plausible?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Source availability, verified mapping, health, time coverage and raw-export status may show whether proposed evidence channels meet technical prerequisites. Coverage: Every planned sampled assertion and its primary and corroborative evidence sources. Timing: At test design, sample selection and immediately before execution. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: A source may be technically healthy but unauthorised, irrelevant, non-independent or missing the authoritative population and criterion context. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - before every sampled test and after any source or population change. Minimum evidence: An explicit criterion and assertion, frozen population, at least one relevant primary source, source owner, permission, provenance, valid period, disclosed limitations and a reproducible method. Method: Pre-test evidence gate; check every required element as present and verified; the gate is binary for testability while evidence weight remains for assessor judgement. Uncertainty: Report required-element coverage, primary-source count, period coverage and unresolved limitation count. Safe failure: Class the assertion untestable and request evidence rather than lowering the gate.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, control owner, source owner and records authority. Primary records: The exact criterion and assertion, control design, authoritative population, evidence-source designation, permissions, provenance and planned procedure. Precedence: The assessor-approved test specification and authoritative source designation outrank source availability or management confidence. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag ambiguous assertions, no population denominator, missing permission, proposed telemetry without verification, source period gaps and management-only claims. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not convert a management claim or plausible telemetry pattern into evidence, weaken the gate to produce an answer, or decide that testability means conformity. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Stops weak or ill-defined tests before they create misleading workpapers.

AU-049

Inaccessible evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which planned observations, systems, records or assets were inaccessible, for what authorised reason, and what proportion of the intended procedure is affected?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Access-control decision status, connector health and current owner-approved closure, outage or safety-permit flags can document inability to access without attempting circumvention. Coverage: Only assessor-selected sample items and their affected strata; inaccessible areas are not sensed indirectly to infer their condition. Timing: At each attempted observation or retrieval and daily until resolved or the assessor closes the request. Verification: Verify reader-controller-door mapping, commissioning, event meaning, clock/time zone, buffering, firmware, expected/received events, uptime/gaps and lineage. Limits: A denied or failed access attempt may arise from safety, privacy, security, outage, technical error or incorrect identity; these reasons have different implications. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + calculation - at each failed access attempt and before fieldwork or report closure. Minimum evidence: Sample item and stratum, requested procedure, attempted time, reason code, authoritative decision or technical evidence, owner and possible alternative evidence. Method: Limitation register and affected-sample calculation; map each limitation to the sample and intended assertion, distinguish temporary from permanent and calculate affected fractions. Uncertainty: Report affected sample and population percentage, duration, strata with zero observation and likely bias direction only where evidence supports it. Safe failure: Do not infer conditions behind the access boundary; request rescheduling, alternative evidence or a limitation decision.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: site, safety, system and data owners plus the assessor. Primary records: Access requests and decisions, safety permits, closure and outage notices, legal or contractual restrictions, sample manifest and owner correspondence. Precedence: Current competent owner or safety decision outranks historical plans, predicted availability and technical workarounds. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Record the reason and authority without exposing restricted details. Flag conflicting access decisions, expired permits, technical failure presented as denial and sample items unavailable for an unknown reason. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not bypass access, safety, privacy or security controls, infer hidden conditions, use the May 2021 plan as proof of current access, or substitute an unapproved sample. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports rescheduling, alternative procedures and precise limitation wording.

AU-050

Reproducible fieldwork

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can another competent assessor reproduce the population, sample, observations, calculations and outputs from the retained fieldwork package?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Immutable extraction manifests, query and algorithm IDs, random seed, observation timestamps, device and software versions and output hashes may support reproducibility. Coverage: The complete assessor-controlled sample and all calculations or telemetry extracts used for the selected procedures. Timing: Captured at each population freeze, sample execution, observation and analysis run; verified again at package closure. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Proprietary systems, expired permissions, mutable queries, local files, undocumented manual judgement and non-repeatable physical conditions can limit reproduction. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + reproduction - at internal check, before external handover and when a result is challenged. Minimum evidence: Frozen inputs, sample parameters, observation protocol, software and rule versions, dependencies, declared rounding tolerance and expected output hashes. Method: Independent rerun and evidence-package verification; re-execute deterministic steps, compare sample and outputs, and separately document non-repeatable observations and professional judgement. Uncertainty: Require identical selected IDs and exact or declared-tolerance output match; report hash differences, unavailable dependencies and non-reproducible steps. Safe failure: Label the affected result not reproducible and show the missing dependency or judgement step.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, evidence custodian and source owners. Primary records: The sampling plan, frozen population, observation protocol, workpapers, scripts, source snapshots, data dictionaries, permissions and environment specification. Precedence: Retained authorised inputs and signed workpapers outrank recreated convenience copies. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing software or source versions, revoked access, unavailable physical condition, undocumented judgement, broken hashes and outputs that depend on an individual's local file. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not claim full reproducibility where physical conditions, proprietary sources or professional observations cannot be recreated, or modify inputs to force a match. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports technical check, challenge and continuity between assessment teams.

AU-051

Exception linkage

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What candidate exception occurred, which criterion, control, asset, process and period does it concern, and which original evidence and contrary evidence are linked?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Alert, failed-test, threshold and workflow-exception IDs may provide candidate event references without automatically creating a finding. Coverage: Candidate exceptions identified by assessor procedures or verified source records, linked at asset, control and period level. Timing: Event-level at detection and every status change, with weekly summaries by criterion and control. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Alerts can be duplicates, expected exceptions or data-quality events; absence of an automated alert does not prove absence of an exception. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at detection, during finding development and before report finalisation. Minimum evidence: Original evidence, exact criterion and clause version, affected control and population, asset or process, period, assessor test and evidence status. Method: Candidate-exception normalisation and exact linkage; create a candidate issue record preserving original wording, link all supporting and contrary evidence and merge duplicates only with assessor approval. Uncertainty: Report unlinked-candidate percentage, duplicate count, affected population and period coverage, and number supported only by proposed telemetry. Safe failure: Keep the matter as an unclassified candidate and request the missing linkage.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, control owner and evidence custodian. Primary records: The assessor's workpapers, original source records, criterion and control register, issue log and owner responses. Precedence: The assessor's documented observation or test result and original source evidence outrank automated issue labels. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive issue detail. Flag candidate items with no exact criterion, no original evidence, duplicate issue IDs, changed wording and conflicts between workpaper, source and owner response. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not classify a candidate as a nonconformity, rewrite the assessor's finding, remove contrary evidence, or treat an alert or failed test as an automatic finding. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Creates a traceable issue population for assessor-led evaluation.

AU-052

Recurrence pattern

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are comparable exceptions recurring across periods, locations, asset classes, suppliers or control owners after allowing for population and coding changes?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Normalised event and asset metadata may support recurrence counts by control, asset class, zone, supplier and time, without ranking individual performance. Coverage: Current and prior candidate or confirmed exceptions whose definitions and criterion versions are demonstrably comparable. Timing: Event-level history with monthly and assessment-period rates using an exposure denominator where available. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Changed taxonomy, scope, detection sensitivity, reporting culture and population size can create false trends or hide recurrence. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - during finding evaluation, corrective-action check and comparison with prior assessments. Minimum evidence: Comparable issue definitions, criterion and control IDs, population or exposure denominator, period, location or asset attributes and status history. Method: Assessor-approved taxonomy mapping, recurrence-rate calculation and cluster check; map issues using explicit rules, calculate counts and rates, and present candidate clusters for assessor validation rather than auto-merging. Uncertainty: Report rate with denominator, confidence interval where valid, taxonomy-mapping uncertainty and sensitivity to alternate grouping. Safe failure: State that recurrence cannot be assessed where definitions or denominators are not comparable.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: quality or compliance, assessors and control owners. Primary records: Current and prior issue logs, assessor findings, corrective actions, criterion and control histories, asset populations and supplier records. Precedence: Original assessor-classified records and point-in-time criterion definitions outrank automated similarity clusters. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect personnel data and avoid owner ranking. Flag incomparable periods, changed labels, merged findings, missing denominators and disagreements about whether issues are substantively similar. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer culpability, systemic failure, materiality or severity from frequency alone, rank teams or suppliers, or merge findings without assessor approval. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor identify patterns that may require broader sampling or systemic corrective action evidence.

AU-053

Extent and consequence evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What verified evidence describes the extent, duration, affected population and consequences relevant to the assessor's severity and risk judgement?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Verified outage duration, affected-asset counts, threshold duration, service state and control availability may provide bounded factual indicators. Coverage: Only the assets, services, periods and populations linked to the candidate matter; no individual harm, behaviour or exposure inference. Timing: Native event timing with daily impact summaries and explicit unobserved intervals. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Telemetry may not capture business, legal, safety or stakeholder consequences; affected-population counts can be uncertain where mapping is incomplete. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + estimate - when the assessor evaluates a candidate finding and when new impact evidence arrives. Minimum evidence: Verified affected population, duration, control state, consequence records, existing and compensating controls, scheme grading criteria and disclosed evidence gaps. Method: Severity fact pack and bounded impact-range analysis, not a severity decision; summarise each severity dimension, calculate supported lower and upper bounds and show which facts depend on representation or proposed telemetry. Uncertainty: Report ranges, affected-population coverage, unobserved duration and sensitivity to disputed sources; do not collapse to a score unless the assessor specifies one. Safe failure: Present the dimension as unknown or bounded and refer classification to the assessor.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the scheme owner, risk, safety, service and control owners. Primary records: Scheme grading rules, approved risk method, incident and service-impact records, complaints where authorised, compensating-control evidence and owner assessments. Precedence: Competent professional and authoritative impact records plus scheme rules outrank analytics-generated risk scores. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive incident and personal information. Flag unverified consequences, estimates without method, population ambiguity and conflicts between technical duration and business-impact records. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not assign severity, materiality or risk rating, infer individual harm, accept risk, or present a telemetry-derived score as a scheme decision. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Gives the assessor a transparent factual basis for independent severity or grading judgement.

AU-054

Root-cause support

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Does the verified timeline support the stated root cause, what alternatives remain plausible, and which specialist evidence is still needed?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Event sequences, configuration changes, device health, maintenance activity and correlated asset states may support a technical timeline without attributing personal blame. Coverage: The affected control and relevant upstream dependencies during a pre-defined investigation window. Timing: Native event resolution retained, with a single UTC timeline and explicit clock uncertainty. Verification: Verify model/location, commissioning, calibration/reference check, sample interval, clock alignment, range checks, uptime/gaps, drift, firmware and lineage. Limits: Correlation, common-cause events, missing logs, post-event changes and differing clocks can create a compelling but false causal sequence. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Diagnosis + comparison - during root-cause check and before accepting a corrective-action rationale. Minimum evidence: Verified timeline, proposed mechanism, evidence for each causal step, at least one disconfirming test where feasible, alternative explanations and specialist check. Method: Causal-evidence matrix and event-sequence reconstruction; separate temporal order, correlation, mechanism and counter-evidence; classify each causal link supported, partly supported, unsupported or untestable. Uncertainty: Report clock range, missing-event intervals, number of unruly alternatives and sensitivity of the conclusion to disputed evidence. Safe failure: State that root cause is not established and list the missing test or evidence.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the investigation lead, control owner and competent specialists. Primary records: The approved investigation record, interviews or management representations, incident, maintenance and change-event records, technical reports and contrary evidence. Precedence: Competent investigation evidence and original point-in-time records outrank an analytics-generated causal narrative. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect interview and personnel information. Flag missing disconfirming tests, retrospective changes, alternative causes not considered, unsupported blame and conflicts between technical and witness timelines. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not attribute fault to a person, assert causation from correlation, conduct an unsafe experiment, or approve the stated root cause or remedy. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor challenge whether corrective action addresses an evidenced cause rather than a convenient explanation.

AU-055

Corrective-action plan

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Does every corrective action have an authorised owner, bounded scope, due date, milestones, acceptance criteria and specified closure evidence?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Corrective-action workflow status, milestone changes, linked asset or control IDs and due-date events may provide role-level progress metadata. Coverage: Every open action linked to a candidate or confirmed issue, including dependencies and affected population. Timing: Event-level on assignment, approval, due-date change and closure request, with weekly ageing summaries. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A status field can be optimistic, bulk-updated or disconnected from actual implementation; closed tickets may lack acceptance evidence. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at plan approval, each governance check and before any closure test. Minimum evidence: Issue and criterion link, authorised owner, exact scope, due date, resources or dependencies, acceptance criteria, required evidence and approval. Method: Corrective-action plan completeness and ageing analysis; check all attributes and temporal history, map dependencies and calculate ageing; do not assess implementation effectiveness here. Uncertainty: Report attribute-completeness percentage, overdue days, dependency count, unapproved extension count and actions with no specified closure evidence. Safe failure: Keep the action status 'plan incomplete' and prevent closure testing.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the action owner, quality or compliance and approving authority. Primary records: The approved corrective-action plan, issue record, governance minutes, resource or contract commitments, change requests and required closure evidence. Precedence: The authorised action plan and approval history outrank workflow labels and informal commitments. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect personnel and commercial detail. Flag missing authority, undefined scope, due-date changes without approval, acceptance criteria added after implementation and actions not linked to the originating issue. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not assign the owner, approve the plan, extend the due date, define acceptance criteria, close the action, or determine the finding status. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Gives the assessor a testable action plan and exposes weak closure conditions early.

AU-056

Corrective-action outcome evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

After implementation, does independent, time-aligned evidence show that the corrective action achieved its stated control objective for the defined observation period?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Post-change configuration state, control events, alert or failure rates and service metrics may provide outcome evidence for a pre-defined observation period. Coverage: The affected control population and a comparable pre-action and post-action window, excluding periods the assessor identifies as non-comparable. Timing: Native events retained, daily or weekly outcome summaries and explicit start of stable post-implementation operation. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Regression to the mean, seasonality, changed detection, short follow-up, concurrent changes and incomplete telemetry can create false positive change. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Comparison + estimate - after the action is stable for the assessor-approved observation period and again if a related exception recurs. Minimum evidence: Approved success measure, verified implementation date, comparable baseline, stable post period, source fitness, confounder log and independent retest or check. Method: Designed retest or pre/post effectiveness analysis; apply the pre-specified test, compare rates or outcomes with exposure denominators and examine whether the evidenced root cause mechanism changed. Uncertainty: Report effect size, confidence interval where valid, follow-up duration, residual recurrence, missingness and sensitivity to concurrent changes. Safe failure: State effectiveness not demonstrated and keep closure for assessor decision.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the action and control owners, independent checker and assessor. Primary records: Implementation and acceptance records, root-cause evidence, approved success criteria, independent retest, recurrence log, change history and contextual records. Precedence: The assessor-approved effectiveness criterion and independent post-implementation evidence outrank action closure status or owner assertion. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag changed definitions, no stable observation period, concurrent interventions, missing baseline, unresolved root cause and post-period evidence selected after results were known. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not declare an action effective because it is marked complete, promise non-recurrence, choose a favourable post period, or close the finding. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports an evidence-based closure decision rather than administrative completion.

AU-057

Action ageing and reopening

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which actions are overdue, repeatedly extended, reopened, partially closed or linked to new related exceptions?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Workflow state transitions, original and revised due dates, extension approvals, closure and reopening events, and linked exception IDs may provide a complete action history. Coverage: All corrective actions in scope, aggregated by issue and control; no individual performance ranking. Timing: Event-level history with weekly ageing and recurrence summaries. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Migrated systems, overwritten due dates, merged actions and inconsistent linkage to new issues can understate ageing or reopening. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation - at each check cycle and before report or certification follow-up decisions. Minimum evidence: Complete status and due-date history, every approval, closure evidence, reopening reason and validated links to related exceptions. Method: Action lifecycle timeline, ageing and assessor-validated recurrence linkage; calculate age from original due date, count authorised extensions and reopenings, and present candidate recurrence links for assessor confirmation. Uncertainty: Report overdue days, extension and reopen counts, time closed before reopening and actions with incomplete history. Safe failure: Show the history gap and do not infer delay, closure or recurrence.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: quality or compliance, action owners and approving authorities. Primary records: The corrective-action register, approved extensions, governance minutes, closure and reopening decisions, and related issue records. Precedence: Original action history and signed approval records outrank current workflow status. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect personnel details. Flag overwritten dates, extensions lacking authority, closure and reopening without evidence, duplicate actions and new exceptions linked only by automated similarity. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer negligence or staff performance, approve an extension, escalate automatically outside authorised workflow, or merge actions based on similarity alone. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor prioritise follow-up and distinguish persistent issues from ordinary open actions.

AU-058

Compensating control

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

While a primary control is impaired, is the approved compensating control active over the same scope and period, monitored and time-limited?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Primary and compensating-control status, heartbeats, alert events, activation and expiry markers may support an overlap timeline. Coverage: The affected control population and approved impairment period, including interfaces and assets the compensating control is intended to cover. Timing: Five-minute state where available, event-level activation or suppression and daily coverage summaries. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: A running compensating control may not be equivalent, properly scoped or monitored; manual compensating activities may have no telemetry. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - at impairment start, throughout the approved period and at restoration or expiry. Minimum evidence: Approved impairment window, exact affected population, compensating-control scope and evidence, monitoring, expiry, restoration criteria and source fitness. Method: Primary-impairment and compensating-control overlap analysis; construct a time-and-population coverage map and identify intervals or assets with neither verified primary nor approved compensating control. Uncertainty: Report uncovered minutes or hours, population coverage percentage, monitoring gaps, expiry overrun and uncertainty from manual operation. Safe failure: Show the uncovered interval and refer the matter immediately to the competent owner; do not assume equivalence.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the primary and compensating control owners, risk and competent professionals. Primary records: The impairment approval, compensating-control design, risk assessment, activation and expiry, monitoring evidence, restoration plan and competent-owner check. Precedence: The approved impairment and compensating-control conditions outrank observed technical availability. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag operation outside approved scope or dates, expired compensation, unmonitored manual steps, uncovered dependencies and conflicts between activation records and technical state. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not authorise, extend or declare equivalence of a compensating control, operate either control, or accept the residual risk. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides a factual basis for assessor check of interim control evidence and uncovered exposure.

AU-059

Waivers and accepted risks

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are waivers, accepted risks and authorised exceptions valid for the exact scope, period and authority, with conditions and expiry visible?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Asset, control and configuration tags may show where an exception appears applied and when its technical condition changes. Coverage: Every waiver, accepted risk or authorised exception cited for an in-scope control, including affected population and period. Timing: Event-level configuration or status change with monthly expiry and scope checks. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Tags can be stale, copied or broader than the approval; manual exceptions may be invisible. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at assessment planning, each sampled exception and before relying on it in reporting. Minimum evidence: Signed approval, authorised approver, rationale, exact criterion or control, affected population, start and end, check date and required compensating controls. Method: Authority, temporal validity and scope-conformance test; match the approval to delegation and observed application, then identify out-of-scope assets or periods. Uncertainty: Report expired days, out-of-scope instance count, missing-check status and population coverage of required compensating controls. Safe failure: Treat the waiver or acceptance as invalid for reliance and request competent check.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: risk, compliance, control owners and authorised approvers. Primary records: The waiver or risk register, signed approval, delegation of authority, rationale, scope, start and expiry dates, check requirements and compensating controls. Precedence: The current signed approval and delegated authority for the relevant period outrank system tags, local emails and prior waivers. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect sensitive risk detail. Flag expired or unsigned approvals, approval outside delegation, application beyond scope, missing check and conflict between register and operating configuration. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not accept or renew risk, authorise an exception, treat a waiver as conformity, or expand its scope based on operational convenience. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents invalid waivers or accepted risks from being used to close an assessment matter.

AU-060

Unresolved candidate matters

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which candidate matters remain unresolved because evidence is missing, conflicting, stale, restricted, outside scope or technically unfit?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Evidence-status metadata, connector health and conflict flags may show why a candidate matter remains unsupported or unresolved. Coverage: All open candidate matters and their required evidence, source, population and period. Timing: Updated when evidence, permission, source health or assessor status changes, with daily ageing summaries. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Technical availability does not resolve evidential relevance, and inaccessible evidence may be unavailable for valid legal, safety or confidentiality reasons. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - continuously through fieldwork and at every close-out decision point. Minimum evidence: For each matter: criterion, assertion, required evidence, current status, owner, due date, permission, source health, affected test and consequence of non-resolution. Method: Unresolved-evidence dependency matrix and ageing analysis; classify the unresolved reason, map dependencies and calculate impact on procedures without predicting the outcome. Uncertainty: Report count and age by reason, affected criteria and population, blocked procedure count and evidence requests with no owner or due date. Safe failure: Keep the matter unresolved and carry the exact limitation forward.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, audit liaison, data owners and competent specialists. Primary records: The assessor's open-request and issue logs, conflict register, permission decisions, source-owner responses and workpapers. Precedence: The assessor's documented evidence need and authoritative owner decision outrank automated status labels. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing owner, uncertain criterion linkage, conflicting originals, denied access, proposed-only telemetry and matters outside the commissioned scope. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not force disclosure, infer a finding outcome, resolve a conflict on behalf of owners, or suppress uncertainty to meet a reporting deadline. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports focused follow-up and transparent escalation of matters that remain genuinely unanswerable.

AU-061

Claim-to-evidence trace

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can every factual statement, table value and chart point be traced to exact source records, transformations, versions and approved workpapers?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Claim IDs, source-record IDs, query and transformation hashes, and chart-data manifests can record the technical path from evidence to presentation. Coverage: Every factual sentence, number, table cell and plotted series in the assessment file; professional judgement remains separately authored by the assessor. Timing: At analysis output creation and every report edit, with a final completeness check before issue. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Copied text, manually transcribed numbers, screenshot-only evidence and later source updates can break traceability or point to the wrong version. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + reproduction - at each report check and before final issue or decision-package handover. Minimum evidence: Unique claim or output ID, exact source record and version, transformation or calculation, evidence status, assessor workpaper and permitted citation. Method: Bidirectional claim-to-source lineage and citation completeness test; trace forward from source to every use and backward from every factual output to source, preserving one-to-many and contrary links. Uncertainty: Require 100% factual-claim linkage; report unsupported or stale-link count, citation coverage and outputs dependent on unverified evidence. Safe failure: Mark the claim unsupported and remove it from direct-support status pending assessor action.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and evidence custodian, with source owners retaining authority over originals. Primary records: The report draft, workpapers, evidence index, source snapshots, transformation records and approved citations. Precedence: The exact retained source version and documented transformation outrank current live-system values or an uncited narrative. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive source links by audience. Flag unsupported claims, source links that now point to a different version, manual values without workpapers and citations that omit contrary evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not invent a citation after the fact, alter a source to match a claim, hide contrary evidence, or trace professional judgement as though it were an automated fact. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables efficient checker challenge and defensible factual reporting.

AU-062

Version effective at event

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which criterion, policy, procedure, configuration and form version was effective at the time of each sampled event?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Document effective-date metadata, configuration snapshots and version-change events may support point-in-time version reconstruction. Coverage: Every sampled event and each governing criterion, procedure, form, threshold, rule and configuration used in its test. Timing: Event-level version changes and a point-in-time reconstruction for each sample. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Overlapping effective dates, back-dated approval, local copies, emergency changes and missing archives can make the applicable version uncertain. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + temporal comparison - for every sampled event and when a version history changes. Minimum evidence: Unique event time, each governing object's effective-from and effective-to or supersession record, version ID, approval and source history. Method: Point-in-time version join and gap or overlap detection; join event time to all governing versions, identify zero or multiple matches and preserve any retrospective correction separately. Uncertainty: Report ambiguous-event count, uncovered period, overlap duration, current-versus-event version difference and clock uncertainty. Safe failure: Show 'applicable version not verified' and do not apply the current version retrospectively.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: document control, scheme owner, change authority and system owners. Primary records: Controlled document histories, criterion and scheme archives, approved change records, configuration archives and sampled event records. Precedence: The authorised version demonstrably effective at the event time outranks the current version and file creation or retrieval date. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag overlaps, gaps, unapproved local forms, records signed using a later template and conflicts between configuration and document histories. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not decide retroactive applicability, rewrite an event using the current procedure, or conceal an overlap or gap in version control. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Ensures each sample is tested against the requirement and procedure actually in force.

AU-063

Retention and retrieval

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

For each record class, are retention, legal hold, disposition and retrieval controls operating across the required period?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Archive-job status, storage tier, checksum verification, disposition queue and sampled retrieval-test latency may provide records-management control evidence. Coverage: In-scope record classes and a risk-based assessor-selected sample across active and archived storage. Timing: Daily archive health, monthly retention and legal-hold checks, and event-level retrieval or disposition records. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: A stored file may be unreadable, detached from metadata or inaccessible; a failed search may reflect indexing rather than deletion; backup is not automatically an archive. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + comparison - at each retention check, before disposition and for assessor-selected archived records. Minimum evidence: Record class, creation and closure dates, applicable retention and hold, disposition status, archive location, integrity check and successful retrieval evidence. Method: Retention-rule matching and sampled retrievability test; calculate required retention end, compare actual state and execute authorised retrieval tests without changing originals. Uncertainty: Report retention coverage, premature or overdue disposition count, retrieval success and latency, unreadable-file rate and hold exceptions. Safe failure: Suspend the affected disposition or conclusion through the authorised owner and mark retrievability unverified.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: records management, legal and system owners. Primary records: The approved retention schedule, legal holds, record-class register, disposal approvals, archive inventories, restore or retrieval tests and incident records. Precedence: Applicable legal or scheme retention and current approved schedule plus legal hold outrank storage defaults or user folder age. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict held and sensitive records. Flag premature disposition, records beyond authorised retention, failed retrieval, unknown format, hold not propagated and conflicts between schedule and system configuration. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not interpret retention law, extend or delete records, lift a legal hold, or treat backup presence as proof of compliant retention and retrieval. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports testing of records-management controls and the continued availability of assessment evidence.

AU-064

Evidence integrity

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can unauthorised modification, replacement or deletion be detected, while every authorised correction remains visible and attributable?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Cryptographic hashes, digital signatures, append-only event logs, version records and deletion tombstones may support integrity and correction history checks. Coverage: Every retained evidence item and transformation used in the assessment, focusing on assessor-selected high-risk or changed records. Timing: At acquisition, each authorised change, transfer and final package closure; periodic verification follows the retention policy. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A hash proves byte equality to a reference, not truth or completeness; administrators, key compromise, missing logs and format conversion can limit assurance. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Observation + diagnosis - at acquisition, after correction or transfer and before reliance or handover. Minimum evidence: Trusted reference hash or signature, unique record ID, original and corrected versions, timestamp, actor or service role, reason, approval and deletion status. Method: Hash or signature validation and version-chain continuity analysis; validate signatures or hashes, reconstruct the version chain and distinguish authorised correction, supersession, withdrawal and unexplained change. Uncertainty: Report validation success, broken-chain count, unexplained changes, revoked-credential cases and intervals with no integrity log coverage. Safe failure: Mark integrity not verified, preserve all available versions and stop dependent reliance.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: records management, security, system owners and evidence custodian. Primary records: The integrity and correction policy, trusted hash or signature records, key and certificate status, system audit logs, correction approvals and original versions. Precedence: The trusted original or independently recorded hash and authorised correction history outrank current file presence. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect security detail. Flag broken version chains, unverifiable signatures, revoked certificates, corrections without reason or approval, unexplained deletion and hash changes after custody transfer. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not claim evidence is tamper-proof, recover or reconstruct deleted content without authority, erase an original, or treat a valid hash as proof that the underlying assertion is true. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to distinguish controlled correction from unexplained alteration.

AU-065

Reproducible calculations

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can every extraction, join, filter, calculation and chart be rerun from authorised inputs with the declared method, version and tolerance?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Query and job IDs, code and environment version, parameter files, source and output hashes and schema versions can capture computational provenance. Coverage: Every analytical output cited in workpapers or reporting, including telemetry aggregation, sampling calculations and reconciliation tables. Timing: At each run, with immutable inputs and parameters; rerun at check and after any authorised correction. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Non-deterministic functions, mutable live queries, locale or timezone changes, floating-point behaviour and hidden spreadsheet formulas can change results. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + reproduction - at technical check, after correction and before final handover. Minimum evidence: Immutable inputs, exact code and environment, parameters, seed where relevant, schema and unit versions, rounding tolerance and expected output hash. Method: Deterministic or tolerance-bounded rerun verification; run in a clean environment, compare intermediate and final outputs and investigate differences without changing the baseline. Uncertainty: Report exact match or declared numerical tolerance, mismatched rows or cells, dependency differences and outputs that cannot be rerun. Safe failure: Label the output non-reproducible and remove it from direct support until resolved.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: analysts, data owners and the evidence custodian. Primary records: The source snapshots, scripts or notebooks, data dictionaries, approved methods, dependency lock, rounding rules and output manifests. Precedence: The authorised retained source snapshot and approved method version outrank a live rerun on changed data. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict code and data as required. Flag hidden manual edits, unpinned dependencies, changed query text, missing random seed, unsupported formula and output without source hash. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not tune inputs or code to force a match, overwrite the original output, disclose restricted data or software, or treat numerical reproduction as validation of the criterion conclusion. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Provides a reliable technical basis for checker verification and later re-execution.

AU-066

Time alignment

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are event time, device time, gateway time and server time aligned closely enough, with time zones and daylight-saving handled, to support the claimed sequence?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: NTP or PTP status, device clock offset, gateway receive time, server timestamp and source event time can quantify temporal alignment across systems. Coverage: All sources used in a sampled event sequence, including sensors, tickets, access systems and document approvals. Timing: Five-minute clock health plus event-level source and receive timestamps, stored in UTC with original timezone retained. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Offline devices, manual clocks, daylight-saving ambiguity, buffering and post-event upload can make exact order unknowable. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation + comparison - for every multi-source timeline and after a clock or timezone configuration change. Minimum evidence: Original timestamp, timezone, receive time, clock source and offset evidence for every event source, plus declared ordering tolerance. Method: UTC normalisation, clock-offset estimation and uncertain-order analysis; convert with retained originals, calculate offset ranges and classify event pairs ordered, simultaneous within tolerance or order-uncertain. Uncertainty: Report maximum and median skew, offset uncertainty, number of uncertain-order pairs and periods without verified synchronisation. Safe failure: Present a time range or partial order and do not invent exact sequence.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: platform, system and engineering owners. Primary records: Time configuration, synchronisation logs, timezone registry, device maintenance, outage records and source data dictionaries. Precedence: Verified source clock and synchronisation evidence for the event period outrank current clock status or file timestamps. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag unknown timezone, DST overlap or gap, sync loss, offset correction after the event, differing clock authorities and timestamps derived during transformation. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not manufacture temporal order, use retrieval time as event time, or hide daylight-saving and buffering ambiguity in a single timestamp. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Makes incident, response and control timelines honest and reproducible.

AU-067

Package regeneration

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can the complete evidence package be regenerated from controlled sources, snapshots and documented rules without relying on personal or uncontrolled files?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Automated extraction manifests, connector versions, package-build logs, source and output hashes and dependency checks may support a clean rebuild. Coverage: Every source, workpaper input, telemetry extract and derived output required by the authorised package specification. Timing: At initial package build, internal check and archival verification. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Expired permissions, unavailable source versions, local annotations, manual downloads and proprietary viewers can prevent complete regeneration. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Reproduction + comparison - at check, before decision handover and at retention-based verification intervals. Minimum evidence: All authorised sources accessible or preserved, version-pinned rules and tools, manual instructions, permissions, expected file and record manifest, and hashes. Method: Clean-room evidence-package rebuild and manifest comparison; build in a separate controlled workspace and compare file set, record counts, hashes, metadata and known manual components. Uncertainty: Report regenerated-component percentage, missing or changed files, hash and record-count differences and dependencies no longer available. Safe failure: Label the package only partially regenerable and identify the irrecoverable component.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the evidence custodian, assessor, source owners and records management. Primary records: The approved package specification, source list, scripts, source snapshots, access rights, storage locations, manual-step register and dependency inventory. Precedence: Authorised source snapshots and signed package specification outrank an individual's working folder or regenerated live extract. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing source access, local-only evidence, version drift, manual steps without instructions, unavailable viewer and conflicts between archived manifest and current package. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not bypass expired or denied permissions, substitute a live source for a retained point-in-time snapshot without disclosure, or claim completeness when local-only evidence is missing. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Reduces dependence on individual working files and supports continuity, check and retention.

AU-068

Record state history

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are current, superseded, corrected, withdrawn and deleted record states distinguishable and traceable for the permitted retention period?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Version events, status flags, replacement links and deletion tombstones can expose record-state transitions without presenting old content as current. Coverage: All evidence items with a changed lifecycle state during the assessment or retention period. Timing: Event-level state changes with a point-in-time current-state snapshot and period-end history manifest. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Systems may overwrite rather than version, use inconsistent status labels or delete metadata with content, making history incomplete. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + sequence comparison - at ingestion, when a record changes state and before report or package finalisation. Minimum evidence: Unique record ID, every state transition, effective time, reason, authority, replacement or predecessor link and retention status. Method: Record-state timeline and replacement-link integrity analysis; reconstruct the lifecycle and test that current, superseded, corrected, withdrawn and deleted states are mutually clear and traceable. Uncertainty: Report orphan replacement links, ambiguous current-state count, unauthorised deletion and history coverage percentage. Safe failure: Do not use the item as current evidence and show the unresolved state.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: records management, document control and source owners. Primary records: The controlled document or record history, correction and withdrawal approvals, retention and disposal logs, replacement records and current-state designation. Precedence: The authorised state history and replacement link outrank file naming, folder location or latest-modified timestamp. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Respect lawful deletion and retention restrictions. Flag records with no current-state indicator, replacement without link, deleted item without authority, and superseded content cited as current. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not resurrect lawfully deleted content, treat superseded material as current, erase a withdrawn record from history, or infer the reason for deletion without authority. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Prevents the assessment from relying on the wrong record version while preserving an honest history.

AU-069

Analytics version trace

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which model, rule, query, threshold, configuration and input version produced each analytical output used in the assessment file?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Model or rule execution IDs, configuration hashes, feature and schema versions, threshold values, input references and output confidence fields can capture analytic context. Coverage: Every analytic output used for evidence discovery, anomaly flagging, aggregation or reporting; no model output is treated as a finding. Timing: At every execution and configuration change, with period summaries of version use. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Silent model updates, changed features, threshold overrides, upstream schema drift and missing execution logs can make identical labels non-comparable. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + reproduction - before any analytic output is used and whenever a model, rule, threshold, query or schema changes. Minimum evidence: Execution ID, exact model or rule and configuration version, input IDs, feature and schema version, threshold, timestamp, validation status and output. Method: Output-to-analytic-version linkage and change-period analysis; link every output to runtime and registry evidence, identify periods of version change and rerun selected outputs where authorised. Uncertainty: Report unlinked-output percentage, version-change dates, rerun match, confidence calibration where valid and outputs from expired or unvalidated versions. Safe failure: Treat the output as unverified context and prevent it from supporting a claim.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: analytics, system and control owners, with assessor oversight of use. Primary records: The model or rule registry, approvals, validation and monitoring records, threshold source, query library and change history. Precedence: The approved version and threshold effective at execution outrank current model documentation or a reproduced label. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive code and features. Flag unregistered versions, outputs without execution ID, changed thresholds without approval, invalidated models and conflicts between registry and runtime logs. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not treat an analytic label as a finding, retrain a model, change a threshold, infer protected traits or human behaviour, or conceal version drift. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables the assessor to understand and reproduce the analytics that shaped evidence discovery or summaries.

AU-070

Evidence access trail

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can authorised access, export, sharing, redaction and receipt of evidence be traced by role, purpose, object and time?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Access, export, share and redaction events, recipient domain, file or record ID and permission decision may provide a role-based handling trail. Coverage: In-scope evidence repositories and packages; identity is displayed only where necessary and authorised for accountability. Timing: Event-level with daily exception summaries and retention aligned to security and evidence-handling policy. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Log gaps, administrator access, shared accounts, offline copies and external recipient systems can make the trail incomplete. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + sequence comparison - at access or disclosure, during periodic check and before package closure. Minimum evidence: Actor identity under restricted view, role, purpose, evidence object, operation, time, recipient, approval and resulting package ID. Method: Event-to-authorisation matching and exception check; match each event to active authorisation and reconstruct downstream transfer where logs permit. Uncertainty: Report authorised-event percentage, unknown or unauthorised count, unlogged transfer gaps, redaction events and log-coverage limitations. Safe failure: Escalate through the authorised governance route and label the trail incomplete.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: evidence custodians, information governance, security and the assessor. Primary records: The access and disclosure policy, approved recipient list, evidence register, system logs, redaction decisions and incident records. Precedence: Authoritative access approvals and trusted logs outrank email recollection or file access timestamps. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect identities and security detail. Flag unknown actor or purpose, access outside approved role, export without manifest, redaction without authority and conflicts between repository and transfer logs. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not publish identities broadly, infer misconduct from access alone, claim that absent logs prove no access occurred, or revoke access or initiate disciplinary action. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports accountability, confidentiality check and investigation of handling exceptions.

AU-071

Supported report facts

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which proposed report facts are directly supported, which require qualification, and what exact evidence citation belongs with each statement?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Claim-to-source links, source verification status, coverage and quality metrics may support factual citation without generating an assurance opinion. Coverage: Every proposed factual sentence, value and chart in the report draft, excluding assessor judgement and certification decision text. Timing: At drafting and every material edit, with a final claim-support check before issue. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A linked source may be stale, partial, contradictory or proposed-only; citation presence alone does not establish support. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at draft creation, check and finalisation. Minimum evidence: For each statement: exact claim, scope and period, one or more verified sources, transformation, workpaper, contrary evidence, limitation and permitted citation. Method: Claim substantiation and citation qualification; classify directly supported, supported with qualification, management representation, contextual or unsupported; the assessor validates all wording. Uncertainty: Report citation coverage, unsupported and qualified claim counts, source independence and population or time coverage for each claim. Safe failure: Leave the statement unsupported and prevent it from entering the factual draft.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor for the report and source owners for underlying evidence. Primary records: The draft report, signed workpapers, evidence index, source snapshots, criterion and scope records. Precedence: Verified authoritative evidence for the stated population and period plus assessor-approved workpaper interpretation outranks automatically generated narrative. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Apply audience permissions to citations. Flag claims using unverified telemetry, evidence outside scope or period, unresolved conflicts, missing workpaper approval and source links that disclose restricted detail. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not write or approve an assurance opinion, finding or conclusion, decide materiality, or turn an unsupported or management-only claim into factual reporting. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Helps the assessor build a report whose factual statements can be checked quickly and precisely.

AU-072

Required qualifications

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which statements require explicit qualification for sampling, missingness, source conflict, restricted access, timing, calibration or measurement uncertainty?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Coverage, missingness, clock, calibration, source-conflict and sample-design metrics can quantify the limitations attached to each proposed statement. Coverage: Every report claim and its supporting population, sample, period and evidence sources. Timing: At test completion and whenever evidence or scope changes, with final reconciliation before report issue. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Aggregated limitation metrics can hide directional bias or a critical missing stratum if not linked to the exact claim. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Recommendation + comparison - at test closure, report drafting and final check. Minimum evidence: For each claim: intended population and period, sample design, source coverage, missing intervals, uncertainty, access restrictions and unresolved conflicts. Method: Limitation-to-claim impact mapping and quantitative caveat support; determine which dimensions the limitation affects and provide factual metrics and bounded alternatives for assessor-authored qualification. Uncertainty: Report affected population percentage, missing period, sample error where valid, measurement range and unresolved-conflict count. Safe failure: Mark the claim as requiring qualification and do not produce unqualified wording.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and relevant evidence owners. Primary records: The limitation register, sampling plan, source-quality records, permission decisions, conflict log and assessor workpapers. Precedence: The assessor's documented limitation and original quality evidence outrank automated caveat wording. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect restricted reasons where necessary but retain their effect. Flag limitations not linked to claims, caveats removed during editing, unknown bias and conflicts between workpaper and report wording. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not decide whether a limitation is material, omit an inconvenient caveat, write the assurance qualification, or suggest that a quantified percentage removes judgement. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports precise, evidence-based qualification rather than vague boilerplate.

AU-073

Neutral coverage reporting

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

How can population coverage, procedures completed and unresolved gaps be reported factually without implying a pass, fail, score or outcome?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Verified source availability, test status, sample coverage and open-gap metadata may support neutral counts and percentages. Coverage: All scoped criteria and planned procedures, using fixed denominators approved by the assessor. Timing: Daily during fieldwork and frozen at report cut-off, with every denominator and status definition versioned. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Traffic-light colours, composite scores and hidden unknowns can be interpreted as conformity ratings even when intended only as progress indicators. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Calculation - during fieldwork and at the reporting cut-off. Minimum evidence: Frozen scope and procedure denominators, explicit status definitions, evidence and test completion, sample coverage and unresolved limitations. Method: Neutral coverage and completion summary; show counts and percentages separately for verified, partial, unavailable, not tested, not applicable by assessor decision and unresolved; avoid composite scoring. Uncertainty: Report denominator, numerator, cut-off time and unknown count for every percentage, plus changes since the prior snapshot. Safe failure: Suppress the metric where the denominator or status definition is not verified.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor and audit liaison. Primary records: The approved scope, test plan, evidence matrix, sample manifest, limitation and open-item registers. Precedence: Assessor-approved status definitions and frozen denominators outrank dashboard defaults. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive gaps by audience. Flag changed denominators, tests counted complete without checker sign-off, unknown merged into not-tested and visual elements that imply grading. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not create a pass/fail traffic light, maturity score, rank, certification probability or implied conclusion, and must not label an item not applicable without assessor authority. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Communicates assessment progress and evidence gaps without prejudicing the independent conclusion.

AU-074

Criterion evidence matrix

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can a criterion-level matrix link requirements, controls, owners, sources, procedures, samples, exceptions, limitations and workpapers without generating conclusions?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Registered source and status links can populate factual relationships among criteria, controls, evidence and sampled records without creating a conclusion. Coverage: In-scope criterion and its full chain to planned and completed procedures. Timing: Updated on authorised relationship or status change and frozen at report cut-off. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Automated joins can create false links where IDs are reused, names change or mappings are many-to-many and unresolved. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - at planning, test completion and report or decision-package preparation. Minimum evidence: Unique versioned IDs for every criterion, control, owner, source, procedure, sample, issue and limitation, with authorised relationship records. Method: Relational completeness and referential-integrity analysis; build bidirectional links, preserve one-to-many relationships and expose missing, duplicate and disputed links. Uncertainty: Report relationship-completeness percentages, orphan count, duplicate links and criteria with no completed procedure or verified source. Safe failure: Leave the relationship unresolved and do not auto-populate a criterion status.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, document control and source or control owners. Primary records: The criterion crosswalk, control and owner registers, source catalogue, test plan and workpapers, sample manifest, issue and limitation logs. Precedence: Authorised unique IDs and point-in-time versions outrank text similarity or name matching. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict sensitive rows by audience. Flag missing IDs, duplicate relationships, version mismatch, unmapped items and conflicts rather than auto-filling them. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not infer missing relationships from text similarity, auto-complete the matrix, determine that a criterion is met, or conceal orphan evidence and controls. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Gives assessors and decision checkers a navigable, traceable view of the complete assessment file.

AU-075

Management representation need

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Which matters require a formal management representation because independent evidence is unavailable, incomplete or solely management-held?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Evidence-status and independence metadata can identify assertions lacking an independent source. Coverage: All material assertions in the assessor's plan, especially future intent, completeness claims and matters outside available source systems. Timing: At test closure and report preparation, updated when independent evidence becomes available. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A source can appear independent while still controlled by management, and absence of telemetry does not by itself justify a representation. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Recommendation + lookup - when a planned assertion lacks sufficient independent evidence and before report finalisation. Minimum evidence: Exact assertion, criterion, period and population, reason independent evidence is absent, known contrary evidence, required signatory authority and intended use. Method: Representation-need register and authority check; map each gap to a specific proposed representation and verify authority and scope without drafting a conclusion. Uncertainty: Report representation count, affected criteria, independent-evidence deficit and statements relying solely or partly on management representation. Safe failure: Leave the assertion unsupported and request assessor direction; do not broaden the representation.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: management, the assessor, legal and governance. Primary records: The evidence request and limitation registers, management representation policy and template, authority register and prior representations. Precedence: The assessor's identified evidence gap and scheme requirements determine the need; a representation remains management evidence regardless of signature. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Protect sensitive statements. Flag unclear signatory authority, broad wording, post-dated scope, unsupported completeness assertions and representations inconsistent with known evidence. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not compel or select a signatory, draft misleading wording, treat a representation as independent evidence, or decide that it resolves a finding or limitation. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports targeted, transparent representation requests instead of broad defensive letters.

AU-076

Outstanding evidence

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What verified evidence, owner clarification or competent specialist judgement remains outstanding before fieldwork closure or decision handover?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Evidence-request status, connector health, export validation and source-owner response metadata may show whether outstanding items are technically and procedurally available. Coverage: All open items linked to planned procedures, candidate findings, limitations and decision-package prerequisites. Timing: Updated on every request, response or status change, with daily ageing and critical-path summaries. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A technically delivered file may still be irrelevant, unauthorised, stale or incomplete; specialist judgement may not be representable as data. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Recommendation + lookup - at fieldwork close-out, report finalisation and before decision-package handover. Minimum evidence: For every open item: criterion or test, exact requested evidence or judgement, owner, due date, status, dependency, verification gate and consequence if unresolved. Method: Evidence-dependency and critical-path analysis; order items by dependency and ageing, show which procedures or decision prerequisites remain blocked and preserve assessor priority. Uncertainty: Report blocker count, age, affected criteria, unresolved critical path and delivered-but-unverified items. Safe failure: Keep fieldwork or package status incomplete for the affected dependency and show the precise outstanding need.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, audit liaison, source owners and competent specialists. Primary records: The open-item tracker, test results, unresolved conflicts, specialist reports, scheme decision prerequisites and owner correspondence. Precedence: The assessor's documented need and scheme prerequisite outrank completion flags in a request tracker. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag missing owner or due date, response not addressing the request, unverified source, specialist check pending and conflicts between fieldwork closure and decision-package requirements. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not declare the assessment ready for certification, waive a prerequisite, substitute generic evidence, or pressure a specialist to give a predetermined judgement. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Supports disciplined close-out and prevents unresolved dependencies from disappearing at handover.

AU-077

Prior-period comparability

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Are prior-period comparisons valid after reconciling scope, criteria, populations, methods, deployment, calibration and data-quality changes?

Sensors and telemetry - Proposed support only: Comparable source definitions, aggregation, deployment and health metrics may show whether current and prior telemetry-derived measures use the same basis. Coverage: Only measures and issue counts with demonstrably comparable scope, definition, population, period and method. Timing: At comparative analysis, using frozen prior and current snapshots rather than live dashboards. Verification: Verify asset-baseline mapping, collection method, clock alignment, expected/received records, completeness, configuration version, integrity hash and lineage. Limits: Changed standards, sample design, detection sensitivity, sensor coverage, denominators and reporting practice can create false positive or negative change. Privacy: Asset/system/zone/time-window output only; no identity, tracking, audio, video or communications content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Comparison + estimate - before including any trend or prior-period comparison in reporting. Minimum evidence: Prior and current definitions, scope, population, criteria, sample design, source coverage, quality metrics and known methodological changes. Method: Comparability bridge and sensitivity analysis; create a comparability matrix, harmonise only where justified and decompose observed difference into denominator, method, coverage and residual components. Uncertainty: Report comparable fraction, effect range under alternate harmonisations, confidence intervals where valid and explicit breaks in series. Safe failure: State 'not comparable' and report periods separately.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, scheme owner and source owners. Primary records: Prior and current scopes, criteria and versions, test and sampling plans, evidence inventories, population registers, limitation logs and issued reports. Precedence: Issued prior records and frozen current evidence with harmonised definitions outrank headline comparisons or dashboard trends. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag breaks in series, changed issue taxonomy, different samples, newly visible evidence and prior limitations that prevent comparison. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not imply positive or negative change from different scopes or methods, retrofit prior results to a current criterion without authority, or create a trend from non-comparable samples. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Allows a defensible comparison or an honest decision not to compare.

AU-078

Audience disclosure

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

What evidence and level of detail may be disclosed to each authorised report, certification-file and external-summary audience?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Classification labels, redaction state, disclosure approvals and package-access logs may support audience-specific release controls without using raw content as a permission signal. Coverage: Every evidence item, citation, appendix, image, asset location and personal, security or commercial field proposed for an output. Timing: At drafting, redaction, release approval and every disclosure, with immutable package version and recipient record. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Automated redaction can miss context, metadata, hidden layers, filenames and small-population re-identification risk. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - before every internal, certification-body or external release. Minimum evidence: Purpose and recipient, package version, field-level classification, disclosure authority, required redaction, retention and transfer safeguards. Method: Audience-by-field disclosure matrix and redaction verification; generate an audience-specific copy, inspect text, images, metadata, attachments and hidden content, then compare to the authorised matrix. Uncertainty: Report withheld-field count, redaction verification, residual-risk assessment where available and any content whose disclosure authority is unresolved. Safe failure: Block release and route the item to the authorised owner or governance function.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor, scheme owner, information governance, legal and security. Primary records: The engagement, scheme publication rules, confidentiality terms, legal and privacy requirements, security classification, source-owner approvals and recipient list. Precedence: Applicable law, contract, scheme rule and current owner approval for the named audience outrank convenience or prior disclosure. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Flag audience mismatch, licence-restricted text, residual metadata, small-cell disclosure, uncontrolled annexes and conflicts between owner and scheme disclosure requirements. Show source age in days or owner-defined check cycles, preserve effective, observed, retrieved and processing times separately, and retain conflicting originals with the named resolver rather than silently choosing one. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not disclose personal, research, security-sensitive, licensed or commercially confidential information, circumvent a restriction, or decide publication policy. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Enables safe, proportionate reporting to different audiences without corrupting the source evidence.

AU-079

Neutral factual draft

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Can a neutral factual draft keep verified observations, calculations, management statements, limitations and assessor judgements visibly separate?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Verified facts and calculations can be inserted with evidence-status tags, citations, period and coverage. Coverage: Only assessor-approved factual sections and tables; finding, recommendation, opinion and certification text remain blank for assessor authorship. Timing: At draft generation and each refresh, with the source cut-off and package version stated. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: Language models or templates can overstate certainty, merge evidence classes, omit contrary evidence or paraphrase a criterion inaccurately. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Recommendation + lookup - only after the assessor approves the source set and again after authorised evidence changes. Minimum evidence: Every factual sentence linked to verified source and workpaper, explicit status for representation or limitation, approved terminology and an empty judgement field. Method: Template-based factual synthesis with sentence-level evidence-status controls; generate short factual statements, retain exact quantities and caveats, run citation and prohibited-language checks, and require assessor validation line by line. Uncertainty: Require 100% factual-sentence citation; report unsupported sentence count, mixed-status sentences and source changes since the last draft. Safe failure: Omit the sentence or retain a clearly marked open item for assessor action.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the assessor for narrative and evidence owners for source facts. Primary records: The verified evidence index, signed workpapers, management representation and limitation registers, approved terminology and report template. Precedence: Assessor-approved workpapers and exact source citations outrank generated prose. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict generated content to authorised audiences. Flag any sentence without a citation, mixed evidence status, unsupported adjective, altered criterion language or omitted limitation or contrary item. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not write a finding, recommendation, assurance opinion, conclusion or certification wording, imitate the assessor's signature, or present generated text as approved. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Speeds factual drafting while keeping judgement, wording approval and assurance responsibility with the assessor.

AU-080

Certification decision package

STAKEHOLDER QUESTION

Does the authorised decision-maker's package contain every required final component, unresolved matter, limitation, independence check and integrity record?

Sensors and telemetry - No physical sensing is justified. Proposed read-only support: Package manifest, file and record hashes, completion status, unresolved-item links and evidence-access controls may show whether required components are present and unchanged. Coverage: The complete scheme-required decision package, including report, workpapers or references, findings, representations, limitations, independence checks and unresolved matters. Timing: At package assembly, lead-assessor approval, handover and decision check, with immutable versioning. Verification: Validate connection, schema/control totals, source and transformation versions, clock/time-zone meaning, completeness, duplicates, permission and lineage; calibration is not applicable. Limits: A complete manifest does not mean the evidence is sufficient or the assessment conclusion is correct; restricted items may require controlled access rather than inclusion. Privacy: Role/asset/system/time-window output only; suppress unnecessary personal data and content.

Analysis required - Operation and interval: Lookup + comparison - before handover and whenever the package changes before the authorised decision. Minimum evidence: Every scheme-required component, final version and approval, exact unresolved-matter and limitation list, representation status, independence check, access route and manifest hash. Method: Decision-package completeness, integrity and prerequisite matrix; check presence, version, approval, linkage and integrity; present unresolved items and boundaries prominently without recommending an outcome. Uncertainty: Require 100% manifest match for required components; report missing, superseded, unsigned or inaccessible components and package hash status. Safe failure: Block handover or mark the package incomplete for the authorised body to resolve.

Authoritative supporting data - Owners: the lead assessor and authorised certification body functions. Primary records: The certification scheme's decision requirements, final assessor report, approved workpapers, findings and actions, representation and limitation registers, independence records and package manifest. Precedence: Scheme decision rules and final signed assessor outputs outrank dashboard status or generated summaries. Times/provenance: separate effective, observed, retrieved and processed times; preserve version, approver/record ID, extraction method and lineage. Permission, staleness and conflicts: Restrict decision and security information. Flag missing signatures or required components, unresolved items omitted from the manifest, superseded files, checker conflicts and handover outside approved custody. Apply the owner refresh cycle; retain conflicting originals and name the authorised resolver.

Answer boundary - Must not recommend, make, vote on, sign or issue a certification decision, conceal unresolved matters, alter the assessor's final report, or communicate an outcome before authorisation. No conformity or severity decision; no certification/sign-off, assurance opinion, undisclosed sample selection, evidence alteration, control authorisation or substitution for independent professional judgement.

Why this is useful - Gives the authorised decision-maker a complete, traceable and explicitly bounded package for independent check.

Assessment evidence gates and decision outputs

1. Authority

Purpose, source access, retention, transfer and audience are authorised.

2. Boundary

Entity, location, system, process, period and exclusion are signed and current.

3. Mapping

Source IDs resolve to the correct asset, location, control, record class and owner.

4. Fitness

Commissioning, calibration/reference status, clock alignment, uptime, gaps, drift and schema are checked.

5. Provenance

Effective, observed, retrieved and processed times, versions, transformations and custody are traceable.

6. Minimum evidence

The claim-specific denominator, period, records and corroboration required by the disclosed method are present.

PERMITTED TECHNICAL OUTPUT STATES

Verified fact

Directly traceable to an authorised current source or assessor observation.

Calculated value

Deterministic result with inputs, formula, denominator, period and tolerance shown.

Bounded estimate or diagnosis

Assumptions, alternatives and quantified uncertainty remain visible.

Qualified statement

A factual statement accompanied by missingness, coverage, timing, conflict or access limitation.

Unresolved

Evidence is conflicting, stale, incomplete, restricted, outside scope or technically unfit.

Not authorised

The requested access, processing, retention, transfer or disclosure is not permitted.

BOUNDARY

None of these states is a finding, conformity determination, assurance opinion, sign-off or certification decision. The assessor and authorised scheme functions retain those judgements.

Rules for bounded, traceable assessor support

Proposed status

Treat sensors, integrations, analytics and mappings as proposed until independently verified for deployment, commissioning, permission, current health and intended use.

Four times

Keep effective time, observed time, retrieved time and processed time separate; show time zone, clock offset and daylight-saving treatment.

Calibration and drift

Where measurement matters, retain instrument identity, calibration/reference method, validity dates, tolerance, range checks, drift evidence and excluded intervals.

Privacy and security

Use the least detailed authorised evidence. Prefer role-, asset-, service-, zone- and time-window outputs; do not identify or track people or inspect communications or research content.

Sampling independence

The assessor defines populations, risk strata, samples, seeds, substitutions and follow-up procedures. The service must not select or conceal undisclosed samples.

Source precedence

Apply law, scheme rules, signed scope decisions, controlled current records and competent owners before dashboards, summaries, historical drawings or inferred states.

Coverage and denominator

State population, asset/location coverage, period, expected records, received records, exclusions, uptime and gaps for every quantitative statement.

Historical plan

Use the May 2021 floor plan only for historical coordinate reference. It cannot prove current room use, access, services, hazards, closures or control ownership.

Conflict handling

Do not silently resolve contradictory sources. Preserve both originals, their times and provenance, state the effect on the claim and name the authorised resolver.

Safe failure

When any required gate fails, state the missing condition, affected scope and period; return insufficient verified evidence and stop the affected operation.

This catalogue organises questions, authorised evidence, technical methods, uncertainty and limitations. It does not certify, sign off, issue an assurance opinion, determine conformity, classify nonconformities, alter evidence, authorise controls or replace independent professional judgement.